

ESL: BEGINNING READING AND WRITING (ESL130)



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(ESL130)

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Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

1: List of Irregular Verbs in English

List of Irregular Verbs in English

Base Form S Form Past Tense Past Participle Present Participle

arise arises arose arisen arising
awake awakes awoke awoke awaking
awakened
be (am is are) ----- was/were been being
bear bears bore borne bearing
beat beats beat beaten beating
become becomes became become becoming
begin begins began begun beginning
bend bends bent bent bending
bet bets bet bet betting
bid bids bid bid bidding
bind binds bound bound binding
bite bites bit bitten biting
bleed bleeds bled bled bleeding
blow blows blew blown blowing
break breaks broke broken breaking
breed breeds bred bred breeding
bring brings brought brought bringing
broadcast broadcasts broadcast broadcast broadcasting
broadcasted broadcasted
burn burns burned burned burning
burnt burnt
burst bursts burst burst bursting
build builds built built building
buy buys bought bought buying
cast casts cast cast casting
catch catches caught caught catching
choose chooses chose chosen choosing
cling clings clung clung clinging
come comes came come coming
cost costs cost cost costing
creep creeps crept crept creeping
cut cuts cut cut cutting
deal deals dealt dealt dealing
dig digs dug dug digging
dive dives dove dived diving
do does did done doing

Base Form S Form Past Tense Past Participle Present Participle

draw draws drew drawn drawing
dream dreams dreamed dreamed dreaming
dreamt dreamt
drink drinks drank drunk drinking
drive drives drove driven driving
dwell dwells dwelled dwelled dwelling
dwelt dwelt
eat eats ate eaten eating
fall falls fell fallen falling

feed feeds fed fed feeding
feel feels felt felt feeling
fight fights fought fought fighting
find finds found found finding
fit fits fit fit fitting
flee flees fled fled fleeing
fling flings flung flung flinging
fly flies flew flown flying
forbid forbids forbade forbidden forbidding
forecast forecasts forecast forecast forecasting
forecasted forecasted
forget forgets forgot forgotten forgetting
forgive forgives forgave forgiven forgiving
forgo forgoes forwent forgone forgoing
forsake forsakes forsook forsaken forsaking
foretell foretells foretold foretold foretelling
freeze freezes froze frozen freezing
get gets got gotten getting
give gives gave given giving
go goes went gone going
grind grinds ground ground grinding
grow grows grew grown growing
hamstring hamstrings hamstrung hamstrung hamstringing
hang hangs hung hung hanging
have has had had having
hear hears heard heard hearing
hide hides hid hidden hiding
hit hits hit hit hitting
hold holds held held holding

Base Form S Form Past Tense Past Participle Present Participle

hurt hurts hurt hurt hurting
keep keeps kept kept keeping
kneel kneels knelt knelt kneeling
knit knits knit knit knitting
knitted knitted
know knows knew known knowing
lay lays laid laid laying
lead leads led led leading
leap leaps leapt leapt leaping
leave leaves left left leaving
lend lends lent lent lending
let lets let let letting
lie lies lay lain lying
light lights lit lit lighting
lighted lighted
lose loses lost lost losing
make makes made made making
mean means meant meant meaning
meet meets met met meeting
mistake mistakes mistook mistaken mistaking
mow mows mowed mown mowing
mowed

overhear overhears overheard overheard overhearing
oversee oversees oversaw overseen overseeing
overthrow overthrows overthrew overthrown overthrowing
pay pays paid paid paying
prove proves proved proven proving
proved
put puts put put putting
quit quits quit quit quitting
read reads read read reading
rid rids rid rid ridding
ride rides rode ridden riding
ring rings rang rung ringing
rise rises rose risen rising
run runs ran run running
saw saws sawed sawn sawing
sawed

Base Form S Form Past Tense Past Participle Present Participle

say says said said saying
see sees saw seen seeing
seek seeks sought sought seeking
sell sells sold sold selling
send sends sent sent sending
set sets set set setting
sew sews sewed sewn sewing
sewed
shake shakes shook shaken shaking
shave shaves shaved shaven shaving
shaved
shear shears sheared shorn shearing
sheared
shed sheds shed shed shedding
shine shines shone shone shining
shined shined
shoot shoots shot shot shooting
show shows showed shown showing
showed
shrink shrinks shrank shrunk shrinking
shrunk
shut shuts shut shut shutting
sing sings sang sung singing
sink sinks sank sunk sinking
sit sits sat sat sitting
slay slays slew slain slaying
sleep sleeps slept slept sleeping
slide slides slid slid sliding
sling slings slung slung slinging
slink slinks slunk slunk slinking
slit slits slit slit slitting
smite smites smote smitten smiting
sneak sneaks snuck snuck sneaking
sow sows sowed sown sowing
sowed

speak speaks spoke spoken speaking
speed speeds sped sped speeding
speeded speeded

Base Form S Form Past Tense Past Participle Present Participle

spell spells spelled spelled spelling
spelt spelt
spend spends spent spent spending
spill spills spilled spilled spilling
spin spins spun spun spinning
spit spits spit spit spitting
spat spat
split splits split split splitting
spoil spoils spoiled spoiled spoiling
spoilt spoilt
spread spreads spread spread spreading
spring springs sprang sprung springing
stand stands stood stood standing
steal steals stole stolen stealing
stick sticks stuck stuck sticking
sting stings stung stung stinging
stink stinks stank stunk stinking
strew strews strewed strewn strewing
strike strikes struck struck striking
stricken
string strings strung strung stringing
strive strives strove striven striving
strived
swear swears swore sworn swearing
sweat sweats sweat sweat sweating
sweated sweated
sweep sweeps swept swept sweeping
swell swells swelled swollen swelling
swelled
swim swims swam swum swimming
swing swings swung swung swinging
take takes took taken taking
teach teaches taught taught teaching
tear tears tore torn tearing
tell tells told told telling
think thinks thought thought thinking
throw throws threw thrown throwing
thrust thrusts thrust thrust thrusting

Base Form S Form Past Tense Past Participle Present Participle

unbend unbends unbent unbent unbending
undergo undergoes underwent undergone undergoing
understand understands understood understood understanding
undertake undertakes undertook undertaken undertaking
underwrite underwrites underwrote underwritten underwriting
undo undoes undid undone undoing
uphold upholds upheld upheld upholding
upset upsets upset upset upsetting

wake wakes woke woken waking
waked
waylay waylays waylaid waylaid waylaying
wear wears wore worn wearing
weave weaves wove woven weaving
weep weeps wept wept weeping
wet wets wet wet wetting
wetted wetted
win wins won won winning
wind winds wound wound winding
withdraw withdraws withdrew withdrawn withdrawing
withhold withholds withheld withheld withholding
withstand withstands withstood withstood withstanding
wring wrings wrung wrung wringing
write writes wrote written writing

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2: Non-continuous Tenses

Non-Continuous Tenses (Active Voice)

Simple Present Tense

I		
You	study	
We	eat	
They	watch	all the time.
-----		every morning.
He	studies	in the evening.
She	eats	
It	watches	

The simple present tense is used in situations that occur generally. They happen all the time or only sometimes, but they are not happening right now. It is also called the habitual present tense because it refers to habits or general truth actions.

Simple Past Tense

I		
He		
She	studied	three years ago.
It	ate	yesterday morning.
We	watched	last night.
You		
They		

The simple past tense is used for situations that are finished and the time must also be finished. It says that something began and ended.

Simple Future Tense with Will and Other Modal Verbs

I		
He	ought to study	many more hours.
She	will study	next year.
It	will eat	tomorrow morning.
We	might watch	tomorrow night.
You	must study	in the library.
They		

The simple future tense is used for actions in the future. Besides “will,” all of the other modal verbs and quasi modal verbs may be used with a future meaning.

Present Perfect Tense

I		
You	have studied	
We	have eaten	
They	have watched	for many years.
		since he was a boy.
He	has studied	all day long.
She	has eaten	
It	has watched	

The present perfect tense is used for situations that began in the past, continue to the present, and may continue into the future. It may also be used for situations that began at some indefinite time in the past.

Past Perfect Tense

I
He
She **had** studied for an hour before I went to bed.
It **had** eaten with some friends when I decided to come home.
We **had** watched in high school when I started college.
You
They

The past perfect tense is used when two related situation occur at different times in the past. The action that happened first uses the past perfect; the action that happened second uses the simple past tense.

Future Perfect Tense

I
He
She **will have** studied all day long in the library before I go out tonight.
It **will have** eaten with some friends before I get home.
We **will have** watched in school by the time you have dinner.
You
They

The future perfect tense is used when two related actions occur in the future at different times. First one action will occur and then the other action will occur. The action that happens first uses the future perfect tense; the action that happens second uses the simple present tense.

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2.1: The Continuous Tenses in English (Active Voice)

The Continuous Tenses in English (Active Voice)

Present Continuous Tense

I	am		
He	is	studying	now.
She	is	eating	right now.
It	is	sleeping	as I speak.
We	are		
You	are		
They	are		

The present continuous is used in situations that are in progress as the speaker is speaking. It emphasizes the action of the verb at this time.

Past Continuous Tense

I	was		
He	was		
She	was		
It	was		
		studying	when I <u>got</u> home from work.
		eating	when the doorbell <u>rang</u> .
		sleeping	when John <u>came</u> home.
We	were		
You	were		
They	were		

The past continuous is used when two actions occurred in the past at the same time. One action was in progress when another action interrupted it. It can also be used alone to emphasize the action of the verb.

Future Continuous Tense with Will and other Modals and Quasi-Modal Verbs

I	will		
He	might		
She	should	be	studying tonight.
It	ought to	be	eating later on this evening.
We	must	be	sleeping next week.
You	may		
They	have to		

The future continuous with will and other modals stresses the on-going action of the modal in the future time. Oftentimes, it is used with two actions in the future.

Present Perfect Continuous Tense

I	have	been		
We	have	been		
You	have	been		
They	have	been	studying	since 10:00 o'clock.
		been	eating	all day long.
He	has	been	sleeping	for three hours.
She	has	been		
It	has	been		

The present perfect continuous says that an action began in the past, continues to the present, and may continue to the future. It stresses that the action of the verb is in progress and not finished as the speaker is speaking.

Past Perfect Continuous Tense

I	had been	
He	had been	
She	had been	studying but stopped before his father <u>came</u> home.
It	had been	eating and then <u>decided</u> to go for a walk.
We	had been	sleeping so <u>didn't feel like</u> going out later in the evening.
You	had been	
They	had been	

The past perfect continuous tense is used when two actions occurred at different times in the past. It emphasizes the first action had been in progress just before the second action began. It says that the first action began and finished before the second began.

Future Perfect Continuous Tense

I	will have been	
You	will have been	
We	will have been	
They	will have been	studying for two hours before she <u>gets</u> home.
He	will have been	eating with my friends before I <u>join</u> my family.
She	will have been	sleeping in the living room before going out (or
It	will have been	<i>before she <u>goes</u> out).</i>

The future perfect continuous tense talks about an action in the future which will be in progress before something else happens in the future.

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2.1.1: Differences in Meaning- Continuous Tenses versus Non-continuous Tenses

Differences in Meaning: Continuous Tenses versus Non-continuous Tenses

The Present Continuous Tense and the Simple Present Tense

I **am writing** this sentence right now.
I **write** sentences for exercises many times a week.
The girl **is washing** her clothes at the laundromat today.
The girl **washes** her clothes at the laundromat every Sunday afternoon.
My sons **are doing** their homework as I write this exercise.
My sons **do** homework almost every evening.

The present continuous tense stresses the action's being in progress as the speaker speaks. The simple present tense stresses the action's habitually occurring and not occurring as a person is speaking.

The Past Continuous Tense and the Simple Past Tense

I **was waiting** for the bus when I saw the accident.
I **waited** for the bus yesterday. An accident happened yesterday.
We bought a newspaper while we **were shopping** yesterday.
We bought a newspaper yesterday. We **shopped** for stuff yesterday.

The past continuous tense stresses two actions' happening at the same time in the past or one action where the speaker wants to emphasize the continuous action of the verb. The simple past tense doesn't show a time relationship. It just says that things happened in the past.

The Future Continuous Tense and the Simple Future Tense

You **will be doing** some homework this evening.
You **will do** more homework in this class this quarter.
My family and I **will be eating** dinner at 7:30 this evening.
My family and I **will eat** dinner at 7:30 this evening.

The future continuous stresses the verb's action being in progress at some time in the future, often when another action interrupts the future action. The simple future only says that something will happen in the future

The Present Perfect Continuous Tense and the Present Perfect Tense

You **have been taking** classes with me all quarter.
I **have taught** three classes this quarter.
My wife **has been taking care of** a sick friend for many months.
She **has cooked** for her friend since January.

The present perfect continuous and the present perfect mean basically the same thing. The difference is that the action in the present perfect continuous is in progress as the speaker speaks. In the present perfect the action does not have to be in progress as the speaker speaks.

The Past Perfect Continuous Tense and the Past Perfect Tense

I **had been cooking** breakfast for 20 minutes before my boys came down to eat.
I **had cooked** breakfast and then I went out to my garden to work.

The past perfect continuous and the past perfect are also very similar. However, the past perfect continuous stresses the action of a verb prior to the following action.

The Future Perfect Continuous Tense and the Future Perfect Tense

I **will have been sleeping** for six hours when my alarm clock rings tomorrow morning.

I **will have slept** for six hours when my alarm clock rings tomorrow morning.

Basically, there is very little difference between the future perfect continuous and the future perfect. The difference is in the stress of the action's being in progress in the future perfect continuous in the future before the second action occurs.

***The continuous tenses **stress the action of the verb**. They “**show**” the action to the listeners or readers, who then “**see**” the action. The non-continuous tenses **stress the idea of the verb**. They “**tell**” the action of the verb to the listeners or readers, who then “**understand**” the action.

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3: Simple versus Perfect Tenses

Simple Tenses versus Perfect Tenses

The **simple tenses** in English (present, present continuous, past, past continuous, future, future continuous, modal and continuous verbs) are called “simple” because their action is locked into one time zone only. There is no movement between the present, the past, and the future. In other words, they look like the diagram below:

l present tense	l	<u>Both of these are locked into the present time.</u>
l	l	
l XXX X XX XX X XXX	l	<i>We go to school every day.</i>
l	l	<i>I sleep at night.</i>
l present continuous tense	l	
l	l	<i>My sons are going to school now.</i>
l ~~~~~	l	<i>The baby is sleeping now.</i>
l _____	l	

l past tense	l	<u>Both of these are locked into the past time.</u>
l	l	
l XXX X XX XX XXXX	l	<i>We walked to the market last night.</i>
l	l	<i>The boy forgot to do his homework last night.</i>
l past continuous tense	l	
l	l	<i>They were driving to the market when the accident</i>
l ~~~~~	l	<i>happened.</i>
l _____	l	<i>She was sleeping when the phone rang.</i>

l future tense	l	<u>Both of these are locked into the future time.</u>
l	l	
l XXX X XX XX XXXX	l	<i>We will be here at 8:AM tomorrow.</i>
l	l	<i>She will make dinner tonight.</i>
l future continuous tense	l	
l	l	<i>They will be leaving at 11:00 Am tomorrow morning.</i>
l ~~~~~	l	<i>I will be sleeping tonight at 4:00 AM.</i>
l _____	l	

The simple tenses are stuck in one time zone only. They cannot show a movement between time zones.

The **perfect tenses** (present perfect, present perfect continuous, the past perfect, the past perfect continuous, the future perfect, and the future perfect continuous), on the other hand, move between time zones. **The present perfect** begins in the past time, moves to the present time, and can continue into the future time. **The present perfect** can also be used with the indefinite past time. What that means is that an action took place in the past, but the speaker or writer does not say when in the past it happened. **The past perfect** moves from the past further into the past for two actions that happened at different times in the past. **The future perfect** moves from a future action to another future action at different times in the future.

Present Perfect and the Present Perfect Continuous Tenses

Past	Present	Future
XX		

*I **have been** a father for 26 years.*

*My son **has lived** in Japan for two years.*

*I **have been typing** this diagram for thirty minutes.*

*The sun **has been shining** since 6:00 AM this morning.*

Past Perfect and the Past Perfect Continuous Tenses

Past Past Present Future

XXXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

*I **had graduated** from university when I **went** into the US Army.*

*My brother **had driven** a truck for many years when he **fell and broke** his back.*

*My son **had been working** on a piece of music for two hours when he **stopped** to take a break.*

*The men **had been sleeping** for six hours when the alarm clock **woke** them up.*

Future Perfect and the Future Perfect Continuous Tenses

Past Present Future Future

XXXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

*My wife **will have cooked** dinner by the time I **arrive** home after work.*

*I **will have been** a teacher for 45 years by the time I **retire**.*

*My son **will have been working** for eight hours today before he **can come** home.*

*I **will have been wearing** my shirt for 11 hours by the time I **get** home today.*

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4: Review Exercises

Review Exercises

Exercise 1: Change the following sentences to the negative, please.

1. I want to buy some new tires for my car soon.
2. It is almost time for a break.
3. He is a very fine young man.
4. My sister loves to play cards with her friends.
5. Some people are always in trouble.
6. I have lots of good vegetables in my garden.
7. Some students are writing these answers on notebook paper.
8. Some of you can speak a lot of languages.
9. We have to learn a lot of English this quarter.
10. I hope that I stay healthy for a long while.
11. We will do a lot of reading this quarter.
12. You should all study hard in school.
13. My son knows how to play the piano very well.
14. My mother always made healthy food for her family.
15. My dog is probably sleeping right now.
16. My student has to go to work right after class.
17. Drinking alcohol makes me sleepy.
18. My sons were doing their homework last week.

19. I always wanted to be a baseball player.
20. A car has four tires.
21. Some people smoke a lot of cigarettes.
22. Reading books will help you learn a lot of new vocabulary.
23. My son listened to some music last night.
24. I am writing this exercise now.
25. We fought with the thief who tried to rob the old lady.
26. This assignment is rather long.
27. Writing English well takes a lot of time.
28. My father drove a taxi for many years.
29. Some boys were playing football in the park.
30. My brother broke many chairs.

Exercise 2: Change the following sentences to Yes/No questions, please.

1. I eat dinner at 8:00 PM every evening.
2. Boys are playing football in the park now.
3. Some of the food on the table is spoiled.
4. We ate pizza at the party on Saturday.
5. My dog had some leftovers after dinner.
6. Young girls like to go shopping with their friends.

7. Eating dinner alone makes people unhappy.
8. My son enjoys hanging out with his friends.
9. My friend worked in Canada last year.
10. The old man lives in a big house by himself.
11. Some children were swinging in the park last night.
12. The radio is on as I write this exercise.
13. Eating healthy food keeps a person healthy.
14. My friends drank a lot of wine at the party on Saturday.
15. The food in the pan smells good.
16. We saw a baseball game in August with our friends.
17. The girl wanted to visit her grandmother in China.
18. Students must learn to read and write in order to be successful in college.
19. We had to power wash the deck before we sanded it.
20. Students study in the morning and evening.
21. The woman lost her purse at the theater last night.
22. We are making questions right now.
23. My son felt bad last night because he ate some fast food.
24. I swept the floor in my house this morning.
25. My favorite student sent me an email message in August.

26. My wife washes the dishes after dinner.
27. My friend fixes cars for a living.
28. Everyone should be polite.
29. Some people sometimes make mistakes in life.
30. I am waiting for a phone call right now.
31. In a nursery rhyme, a cow jumped over the moon.

Exercise 3: Change the following sentences to WH Questions with the question words that follow the sentences, please.

1. We look at flowers in the garden every day.
What
When
2. My friend picked some flowers for her mother.
Who
What
3. You are writing questions right now.
What
When
4. My friend went to his country because he was homesick.
Where
Why
5. My sister must get a new car soon.
What
When
6. We will be watching a movie at 8:00 tonight.
What
When
7. It takes me 25 minutes to drive to college every morning.
Where
When
8. I bought the red shirt for my friend's birthday present.
Which
Whose
9. Learning to write in English takes a lot of time.

How much

What

10. All students should come to class on time.

Who

Where

11. I wrote this exercise during my summer vacation.

What

When

12. My friend speaks to his mother every Sunday morning.

Who

Whose

13. My sister might come to Seattle next year during the summer.

Where

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5: Past Tenses in English

Past Tense Meanings of Verbs in English

Simple Past Tense: Used to describe actions or activities that began and ended in the past. Its emphasis is on the action itself and not on the action's relationship to another action in the past. It simply says, "This happened."

Examples:

*I **went** to the store yesterday, **bought** some milk and eggs, and **returned** home.*

*The United States **fought** in World War Two. Thousands of soldiers **died** in Asia.*

*My father **drove** a cab for many years. He only **had** one accident in all the years that he **drove** cabs for a living.*

*My son **got up** this morning, **ate** breakfast, and **left** for school.*

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5.1: Two Types of Past Tense Verbs- Regular and Irregular

Two Types of Past Tense Verbs: Regular and Irregular

1. **Regular verbs** are verbs that end in **ed** in the past tense affirmative.

Examples: open/opened, start/started, wait/waited, memorize/memorized

2. **Irregular Verbs** are verbs that change form in the past and past participle form.

Examples: go/went, strike/struck, fly/flew, write/wrote, put/put, forget/forgot

The same rules for the negative and question form apply to both types of verbs.

Sample Sentences:

We stayed home last night and ate dinner together.

My father drove a taxi and worked in a factory for many years.

My brother broke the chair and then tried to fix it.

I enjoyed living with my family, but I left home at 22 years old.

We saw a man who needed to buy some medicine.

Forming the Negative: Present and Past Tenses

Present Tense Negative

I	
You	play.
We	don't go.
They	wash.
He	play.
She	doesn't go.
It	wash.

Past Tense Negative

I	
You	play.
We	didn't go.
They	wash.
He	play.
She	didn't go.
It	wash.

After the helping verbs **don't**, **doesn't**, and **didn't** ALWAYS use the **base form** of the verb **in the present tense and in the past tense**.

Use the **S Form of the Verb** only in the present tense for **he**, **she**, and **it**. Never use the **S Form** in the past tense.

Notice that **in the present tense and in the past tense** that the verb always goes back to the **base form** after **don't**, **doesn't**, and **didn't**.

Present Tense Negative Verb To Be

I	am not
He	
She	is not
It	
We	
You	are not
They	

Past Tense Negative Verb To Be

I	was not
He	
She	was not
It	
We	
You	were not
They	

When you change the verb to be from the present tense to the past tense, you use the words **was** and **were**. When you want to make **the past continuous tense**, then the main verb always uses **ing**.

Remember that the words **am**, **is**, and **are** have the same meaning as **was** and **were**. The only difference is the time (tense).

I am in class today. I was in class yesterday.

We are living in Seattle. We were living in different places when we were younger.

My son is at work now. He was in his apartment last night.

Exercise 4: Change the following sentences to the Past Tense Negative, please.

1. We planned to buy a new stove last week.
2. He ate a bowl of soup for lunch.
3. My sister allowed my sons to stay up past their bed time.
4. He remembered to take his wife downtown.
5. She lent \$100 to her friend.
6. The police arrested the robber last night.
7. I forgot to get the bread on my way home.
8. Friday morning was the last day for class.
9. Tom brought his friend to the class.
10. He helped his son fix the car.
11. The girls prepared dinner for their family.
12. I wished to see some old photographs.
13. He invented the electric light bulb.
14. The teacher corrected the students' homework assignment.
15. The soccer star flew to Chicago to join his new team.

Exercise 5: Change the following sentences to the past tense yes/no questions, please.

1. We intended to buy a new lawnmower last week.
2. He made a Vietnamese sandwich for lunch.

3. My friend let his sons sleep late yesterday.
4. He forgot to take his wife to the market.
5. She gave \$100 to her boyfriend for his birthday.
6. The FBI arrested the bank robber last night.
7. I remembered to buy milk on my way home.
8. Last Thursday was the last day for class that quarter.
9. Tom brought his lunch to work.
10. He told his friend to fix the broken window.
11. The girls made a cake for their father's birthday.
12. I hoped to see my old friends.
13. He invented many things in his life.
14. The teacher corrected the students' compositions.
15. The president took a trip to Boston on business.

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5.1.1: Past Modal Verbs Used in the Simple Past Time for Past Repeated Actions

Past Modal Verbs Used in the Simple Past Time for Past Repeated Actions:

Used to, Could, and Would = Simple Past Tense

<u>Used to</u> (used to)	base form of the verb	Past situations; no longer exist; used by native speakers to introduce repeated situations in the past.	Past
-----------------------------	--------------------------	--	------

*I **used to live** in Massachusetts.*

*My sister **used to go** fishing with my father and me.*

*I **used to travel** a lot.*

*I **used to be** a good walker.*

*I **used to go hunting** with my grandfather.*

*My sons **used to play** with toys.*

<u>Could</u>	base form of the verb	Ability to do something	Repeated past ability
To be able to (was, were)		For a single event in the past, use <u>was/were able to</u> ; for repeated past events, use <u>could</u> .	

*When I **was** a young boy and I **visited** my grandparents, I **could** do almost anything I **wanted** to do. First of all, I **could walk** to my grandparents' house because we **lived** close to their house. I **could eat** whatever I **wanted** to eat because I **was** my grandmother's favorite grandchild. I **could watch** TV or I **could play with** my grandfather's hunting dogs. Sometimes I **could go** hunting for rabbits and birds with my grandfather and uncle, too. They **would let** me shoot their guns. My mother **would never let** me shoot guns.*

<u>Would</u>	Repeated actions in the past	Repeated past ability
	<i>I used to live with my parents. I would eat my mother's food every day.</i>	
	<i>I would go fishing with my father. I would go to school every day. We would all have fun at home together. We would always joke around with each other. We would laugh a lot, too.</i>	

Exercise 6: Answer the following questions using **used to**, **would**, or **could**, please.

1. At what time would your mother make dinner when you were in your native country?
2. Who would prepare dinner for your family when you were a child?
3. What could you do as a child that you can't do now?
4. Who used to take care of you when you were very young?
5. Where would your mother go shopping a long time ago?

6. Who could you visit in your country that you can't visit anymore?
7. Who did you use to see every day when you were in your country?
8. Who would you play with when you were very young?
9. At what time would you wake up when you lived in your native country?
10. What kind of food would you eat as a child?
11. What sports could you play in your native country?
12. Who used to teach you when you lived with your parents?

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5.1.1.1: Past Modals for Single Actions in the Past- The Simple Past Tense

Past Modals for Single Actions in the Past: The Simple Past Tense

The past tense of **must**, **have to**, and **has to** is **HAD TO**.

Had to
(**hadda**)

Obligation or necessity in the past

**Past of must,
have to, and has to**

*He **had to take** his daughter to the hospital last night because she had a high fever.*
*He **had to change** the flat tire on his car last night.*
*We **had to pay** our income taxes last year before April 15th.*
*I **had to drive** my wife downtown because she is afraid to drive in the city by herself.*
*My son **had to memorize** a lot of music for his concert.*

Must have + past participle
(**musta**)

**Past conclusion or supposition only;
Never a past obligation: For past obligations, use had to.**

*Sara is a teacher; therefore, she **must have graduated** from a four-year college.*
(conclusion)

*There was some candy on the table and the children were in the room. Now the candy is gone. The children **must have eaten** the candy.* (conclusion)

*She broke her leg playing basketball. It **must have hurt** a lot.* (conclusion)

*When I came home last night, the house was very clean. My wife **must have done** a lot of housework during the day.* (conclusion)

However

*While I was driving home, I got a flat tire, so I **had to use** my spare tire.* (obligation)

*The boy cut his head badly, so he **had to go** to the hospital.* (obligation)

*The toilet broke last night, so I **had to fix** it right away.* (obligation)

Might have + past participle

May have + past participle

Could have + past participle

(**mighta, may, coulda**)

Past situation – maybe it happened,

maybe it didn't. We don't know for sure,

but we do know that it was possible.

*The student didn't come to class yesterday. She **might have gone** to the doctor's. She **might have had** an accident. She **may have gone** shopping. She **could have stayed** in bed. I don't know what happened for sure, but all of the above are possible.*

*My friend bought a lottery ticket. He **could have had** the winning ticket. I don't know, but it is possible.*

*It **might have snowed** in the mountains last night. Then again, it **might not have snowed**.*

*My sons **might have seen** each other this past weekend. I don't know if they saw each other.*

Could have + past participle

(**coulda**)

Past ability or capability to do something,

but you chose not to do it. You had the

opportunity to do something, but you decided not to do it.

A past possibility that you had an opportunity to do, but you chose not to do.

*I lived in Asia for over 5 and a half years, but I never went to Korea. I **could have gone** there many times, but never did.*

*I **could have stayed** in Europe in 1973, but I decided to return to the United States instead.*

*I **could have become** a history teacher if I had wanted to, but I decided to become an English teacher instead.*

*You **could have skipped** school today if you had wanted to, but you decided to come.*

My wife and I **could have gone** to a movie last night, but we were too tired and decided to bag it and not go.

**Should have + past participle
(shoulda)**

Past obligation which you didn't do. Something was the correct or right action to do, but you didn't do it. Something was a good idea or thing to do in the past, but you didn't do it. In other words, you made a mistake.

You were speeding in a car and a policeman saw you and gave you a speeding ticket. You **should have slowed down**, but you didn't.

You had a test last week, but you didn't study for it and you failed it. You **should have studied** for it, but you didn't.

My son went outside without his coat in the rain last week and he caught a bad cold. He **should have worn** a coat, but he didn't.

The students **shouldn't have cheated** on the exam, but they did.

I **should have learned** how to type when I was in high school, but I didn't. As a result, I am a slow typist.

America **shouldn't have gotten** into a war with Iraq, but it did.

Those boys **shouldn't have teased** the new student in the class. He started to cry and then everyone felt bad for him.

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5.1.1.1.1: "Had To" Exercise

"Had To" Exercise

Exercise 7: Change the following sentences to the past. You will need to change "time" words as well as the verbs.

Example: He must buy a new computer today because his old one broke down last night.

He **had to buy** a new computer **yesterday** because his old one broke down **the night before last**.

1. We have to get some books for our son so that he can be ready for his classes.
2. My sister has to take her son to the hospital.
3. Students must do all their homework before they come to school in the morning.
4. Robert has to fix his brother's car so that he can drive to school next week.
5. Children have to go to bed early so that they can be healthy.
6. I must pull out the weeds from my garden before I plant my seeds this spring.
7. You have to do a lot of homework this quarter.
8. The policeman on the corner has to direct traffic every morning this month.
9. The boys have to help their father move some furniture this weekend.
10. His mother must show him how to do his cook chicken tonight.
11. She has to buy a birthday present for her daughter next week.
12. My friend must wash his car this afternoon.
13. The boys' mother has to cook dinner for her sons.

Past Modal Exercise: Should Have + Past Participle

Exercise 8: Consider the following situations and then tell what the people should or shouldn't have done, please.

1. The man lost all his money at the casino on slot machines.
2. The man's friend lent him some of money so that he could gamble again.
3. My car broke down on the highway because the engine was low on oil.

4. My brother lost his job because he argued with his boss and told his boss that he quit.
5. While I was driving to school, I saw an accident in which a man cut off another car while speeding.
6. My mother smoked all her life and died of lung cancer.
7. I borrowed \$1,000 from my friend last year but I haven't paid him back yet
8. Yesterday was my son's birthday, but I forgot it was his birthday.
9. Yesterday at work, my friend felt very bad because he had gotten drunk the night before and he had a very bad hangover.
10. I didn't go to bed until late last night and now I am very tired.
11. My students didn't do their homework.
12. My son had an accident because he was texting while driving.
13. My son didn't call home because he forgot his phone in his room.

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5.1.1.1.1.1: Past Modal Exercise

Past Modal Exercise

Exercise 9: Respond to the following statements and questions, please.

1. Tell me about an obligation that you had as a young boy or girl.
2. What did I eat for dinner last night?
3. My friend worked all day Saturday in his yard, from 8:00 AM until 6:00 PM. How did he feel at the end of the day? What did he do before he went to bed?
4. My younger son had the opportunity to attend the University of Washington, but he decided to attend the University of Puget Sound instead.
5. My son drove my car when it was low on oil, so he ruined the engine of the car.
6. When the robber put a gun to my head and demanded that I give him all of my money, what do you think I did? (two answers)
7. Why didn't my son come home last night?
8. My sister bought me a new shirt at Macy's yesterday, but she didn't have any money with her. How did she pay for the shirt?
9. I got a fine from the library because I brought a book back late.
10. My friend's back hurt her last night. Why did it hurt?
11. My boss ate some spoiled meat last night. What happened?
12. My friend divorced his wife. How did my wife feel?

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5.1.1.1.1.1: Growing Up

Growing Up

I used to live with my parents in Massachusetts when I was a boy. Every day my brother, sister and I would get up and go to school. Before we left the house, my mother would make breakfast for us so that we wouldn't be hungry during the morning. Sometimes I ate bacon and eggs, but I would usually eat cereal and fruit. After we got to school, we would study all day long, and then we would come home. As soon as we got home, we could have a snack before we did our homework. After we did our homework, we could either go out and play or stay in and watch TV. Usually I would go out and play with my friends. In summer, we would play summer sports like baseball and swimming. In winter, we would play winter sports like ice skating and sledding. Once when we were sledding, a friend of mine crashed into a car. Luckily, he didn't get hurt.

Football

I used to play football when I was in junior high school and in high school. Every afternoon right after school was finished, I would go down to the gym, take off my street clothes, and put on my pads and practice jersey. As soon as I was dressed, I would go out to the practice field, do my running and other exercises, and get ready to practice. The team would then run through football plays that we would use for the upcoming game on either Friday or Saturday. First, we would go through the offensive plays and then we would run the defensive plays. The coaches or the team captains would lead us while we were practicing. We would practice for about two hours every afternoon. After that, we would take off our jerseys and pads, take a shower, and go home. When it was time for a game, we would either play at home, or we would have to take a bus to a different town. When I was in junior high school, I always started, both on offense and on defense. When I got to high school, however, I never started a game. I was too skinny and too slow to play with the big boys. Nevertheless, I played on my high school team all four years because I liked playing very much. If I had been a bigger boy, I am sure I would have played a lot more. However, I was too light and too slow, so I would only play when my team was way ahead in games or way behind in games. My "position" during games would always be "bench warmer."

An Exotic Trek

I used to go hiking all of the time. (Of course, this was a long time ago.) I would head off into mountains, jungles, forests, and even sometimes deserts. Many times I would go to certain places just to go hiking. For example, I have walked for over 1000 miles in the Himalayas, the highest mountains in the world. The first time I went there was in 1976, when my friend Roger and I went overland from Iran to Nepal so that we could go hiking. Everyday Roger and I would get up early so that we could get an early start. We also got up early because we would often have to sleep with the chickens. Needless to say, the roosters would signal the start of the day by "singing" their lovely song. We could do nothing else but get up and get going. Daily, the roosters would never allow "sleeping in," so we would roll up our sleeping bags and other gear and start walking. During the day, we would walk through some of the most beautiful countryside in the world. We were not in a hurry, so we could stop any time we wanted to and just admire the beauty of nature. In the background, there would always be very high, snow-capped mountains. One night we spent the evening with a Nepali family in their beautifully carved house. The family lived along the trail and Roger and I just happened upon the house at the time of day when we would normally stop for the day. We were given a corner of the one-bedroomed house to lay out our sleeping bags and get ready for dinner. After dinner, from the porch of the house, when the sun had set into these mountains directly across a deep valley with five waterfalls glistening in the evening's fading light, Roger and I sat with the family, all of us eyeing each other and realizing that we were both as different as we were similar to each other. Soon after dinner, the man of the family took out some paraphernalia of some sort and began setting up for something. Soon he started praying and chanting in the language of that region of Nepal, Helambu. He burned incense, rang bells and chimes, and went through the evening prayer service of the Himalayan Lamists. It was very fascinating and interesting for us. It was one very lucky moment in our lives. The next morning, we got up and continued our hike, as usual. We would see and experience many more events on this hike, and could talk about them afterwards, but perhaps they are for another paragraph.

High School Friends

I used to hang out with and have a lot of fun with a lot of boys my age when I was in high school. My friend Bruce would always pick me and a couple of other guys up before school and drive us to Attleboro High School in Attleboro, Massachusetts. Bruce would arrive at my house at 7:30 AM, and I would run out to his car and jump in. The radio would always be on, and there would be loud, rock and roll music playing. Because I was the first one picked up, I would always sit in the front seat. I would ride "shot gun." We would then go and pick up the other guys. Instead of picking us up, Bruce could have stayed in bed a little longer and

gotten more sleep, but I think he must have enjoyed us and the fun we had on our way to school. We would usually stop on the way to get coffee and doughnuts. Although many of us wanted to get a real breakfast, we couldn't order one because it took too much time. Once we got to school, we would join our other friends and hang around outside until the bell for classes rang. When it rang, we would all go to our separate classes. After school, most of us would go for sporting practice such as for football, basketball, or baseball. We would also sometimes get together in the evening. Of course, we should have stayed home and studied or read a book, but we would go out just the same. We would drive around looking for trouble, getting into trouble, and then getting out of trouble. We were all good boys, but we were a group of boys together. We never got into any real trouble, however. Once when it was snowing and the roads were icy, Bruce was driving too fast and skidded into another car. He may not have seen the car stopped in front of us. I don't know. But I do know that he shouldn't have driven so fast in those weather conditions, but he did and the result was the accident. None of us was hurt seriously, but the accident could have caused injuries because it was pretty bad. Bruce had to have his car repaired and also had to pay a ticket for reckless driving. He must not have been very happy after the accident. When Bruce's car was finally fixed, he would again come each morning to pick us all up and take us to school. Those times and boys are fond memories of my youth.

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5.1.1.1.1.1.1.1: Past Continuous Tense

Past Continuous Tense

The past continuous tense is used to describe two related actions or activities that happened in the past **at the same time**. Its emphasis is on showing the relationship of the actions relative to the duration of time each takes. The action of longer duration uses the past continuous tense; the action of shorter duration takes the simple past tense. It simply says, "While this was happening, something else happened." The second action interrupts the first action that is already happening. **Note:** The past continuous tense may be used for a single action in the past, but this usage is rare and it is employed only when the speaker wishes to emphasize the continuous action of the verb. The past continuous tense can also be used when two or more actions take place in the past for the same duration of time. "While I was working in my garden, my wife was cooking."

Examples of Two Actions at the Same Time:

*While we **were studying**, the telephone **rang**.*

*My front tire **blew out** while I **was driving** home from school.*

*When their mother **was preparing** dinner, the boys **came** home.*

*When I **got** to class, my students **were waiting** for me.*

Examples of Two Actions of Equal Duration of Time:

*While I **was ironing** my clothes, I **was watching** a DVD.*

*While my older son **was taking** a shower, my younger son **was waiting** for him to finish so that he could take a shower.*

*While my son **was driving** my car, I **was sitting** next to him.*

Examples of One Action Use of the Past Continuous Tense

*Yesterday I started working in my garden at 8:00 AM and stayed in my garden until 8:00 PM. I **was working** all day long in my garden.*

*I **was correcting** homework papers for four hours last night.*

*Both of my sons **were still sleeping** at 2:00 PM yesterday.*

*My sons and I **were watching** movies all afternoon long on Saturday.*

Exercise 10: Make one sentence using the following actions. One of the actions will require the past continuous tense and the other one will require the simple past tense.

For example: *pick potatoes in my garden find a piece of glass*

While I was picking potatoes in my garden yesterday, I found a piece of glass.

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1. stop to buy a coffee | drive to school |
| 2. drive to work | get a phone call from my wife |
| 3. talk to my friend | tell him about a problem |
| 4. break a glass | help my wife in the kitchen |
| 5. listen to music | fall asleep |
| 6. work in the kitchen | open a window |

- | | |
|--|--|
| 7. <i>shop with my sons</i> | <i>buy some books for them</i> |
| 8. <i>drink beer with a friend</i> | <i>look at a pretty girl walking across the street</i> |
| 9. <i>have a nightmare</i> | <i>sleep</i> |
| 10. <i>do my homework</i> | <i>call my wife</i> |
| 11. <i>mow my lawn</i> | <i>run out of gas in the lawnmower</i> |
| 12. <i>answer the phone</i> | <i>read the newspaper</i> |
| 13. <i>answer the teacher's question</i> | <i>sit in class</i> |
-

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5.1.1.1.1.1.1.1.1: Simple Tenses versus Perfect Tenses

Simple Tenses versus Perfect Tenses

The **simple tenses** in English (present, present continuous, past, past continuous, future, future continuous, modal and continuous verbs) are called “simple” because their action is locked into one time zone only. There is no movement between the present, the past, and the future. In other words, they look like the diagram below:

l present tense	l	<u>Both of these are locked into the present time.</u>
l	l	
l XXX X XX XX X XXX	l	<i>We go to school every day.</i>
l	l	<i>I sleep at night.</i>
l present continuous tense	l	
l	l	<i>My sons are going to school now.</i>
l ~~~~~	l	<i>The baby is sleeping now.</i>
l	l	

l past tense	l	<u>Both of these are locked into the past time.</u>
l	l	
l XXX X XX XX XXXX	l	<i>We walked to the market last night.</i>
l	l	<i>The boy forgot to do his homework last night.</i>
l past continuous tense	l	
l	l	<i>They were driving to the market when the accident</i>
l ~~~~~	l	<i>happened.</i>
l	l	<i>She was sleeping when the phone rang.</i>

l future tense	l	<u>Both of these are locked into the future time.</u>
l	l	
l XXX X XX XX XXXX	l	<i>We will be here at 8:AM tomorrow.</i>
l	l	<i>She will make dinner tonight.</i>
l future continuous tense	l	
l	l	<i>They will be leaving at 11:00 AM tomorrow morning.</i>
l ~~~~~	l	<i>I will be sleeping tonight at 4:00 AM.</i>
l	l	

The simple tenses are stuck in one time zone only. They cannot show a movement between time zones.

The **perfect tenses** (present perfect, present perfect continuous, the past perfect, the past perfect continuous, the future perfect, and the future perfect continuous), on the other hand, move between time zones. **The present perfect** begins in the past time, moves to the present time, and can continue into the future time. **The present perfect** can also be used with the indefinite past time. What that means is that an action took place in the past, but the speaker or writer does not say when in the past it happened. **The past perfect** moves from the past further into the past for two actions that happened at different times in the past. **The future perfect** moves from a future action to another future action at different times in the future.

Present Perfect and the Present Perfect Continuous Tenses

Past	Present	Future
XX		

*I **have been** a father for 26 years.*

*My son **has lived** in Japan for two years.*

*I **have been typing** this diagram for thirty minutes.*

*The sun **has been shining** since 6:00 AM this morning.*

Past Perfect and the Past Perfect Continuous Tenses

Past Past Present Future

XXXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

*I **had graduated** from university when I **went** into the US Army.*

*My brother **had driven** a truck for many years when he **fell and broke** his back.*

*My son **had been working** on a piece of music for two hours when he **stopped** to take a break.*

*The men **had been sleeping** for six hours when the alarm clock **woke** them up.*

Future Perfect and the Future Perfect Continuous Tenses

Past Present Future Future

XXXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

*My wife **will have cooked** dinner by the time I **arrive** home after work.*

*I **will have been** a teacher for 45 years by the time I **retire**.*

*My son **will have been working** for eight hours today before he **can come** home.*

*I **will have been wearing** my shirt for 11 hours by the time I **get** home today.*

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6: Perfect Tenses in English

The Present Perfect Tense Formation and Explanation

The present perfect tense can be used in TWO very different ways:

1. Present Perfect Tense in the Indefinite Past: The indefinite past is some time in the past, but we either don't know or don't say when in the past.

Examples:

*I **have eaten** breakfast this morning.* You don't know what time. The time, this morning, isn't finished

*My wife **has had** two babies.* My wife is 60 years old, so you know she had the babies a long time ago, but you don't know when.

*I **have lived** in Tunisia and Iran for about two years each.* Obviously this was in the past, but I didn't tell you when in the past.

In other words, the indefinite past is used to introduce a past time topic or event with an indefinite meaning as to when it happened in the past. Its emphasis is on the introduction of the action and not on when it took place. It simply says, "This has happened at some time in the past and I am going to talk about it." **Note:** Once a native speaker is sure that the reader/listener understands the topic, he or she will change to the definite, simple past tense.

More Examples:

*I **have traveled** around the world, and I **have studied** many languages in my life.*

*Americans **have walked** on the moon. I **have seen** pictures of the astronauts.*

*My sons **have both graduated** from university.*

2. The present perfect tense can be used to describe actions that began in the past, continue in the present, and may continue in the future. Thus, the action of the verb is not finished.

Examples:

*I **have taught** English as a second language since 1971.* I began to teach ESL in 1971 and I am still teaching ESL.

*My wife and I **have lived** in Seattle for 36 years.* We came here 36 years ago, and we are still living here

*Seattle **has** always **had** rainy weather.* Throughout history, it had always rained a lot in Seattle.

None of the above actions is finished. They began in the past but are not finished. Compare these to the second set of examples below. These actions finished earlier; I said when they finished. In other words, they finished at a "definite" time in the past. When I want to say when they finished, then I must change to the simple past tense because the time is "definite."

Definite Past Actions

*My wife **had** one baby in 1985 and the other one in 1987.*

*I **lived** in Tunisia from 1971 to 1973, and in Iran from 1974 to 1976.*

In the present perfect tense, you cannot use definite past tense time words because the definite past tense **stops the time**. Remember that it is the "time" that allows for the present perfect to be used with actions that are finished in the past. If we don't say when, *the time*, something happened, then we can use the present perfect. If we say when it happened, then we must use the simple past tense. Look at the sentences below:

*I **have gone** to Disneyland in California.*

*I **went** to Disneyland in California in 1982 and 1992.*

In the first sentence, I said "have gone" because I didn't say when I went. The time was the indefinite past time. In the second sentence, however, I said "went" because I told you the years 1982 and 1992, both of which are the definite past time.

As a result, with the present perfect tense we can not use time words or expressions such as the following list of words:

yesterday

last week

two months ago

when I was a boy

before I got up this morning

last night

All of the above words and expressions (and many others) put the time of the action in the definite past time. Thus, with these expressions we need to use the definite past tense.

On the other hand, we can use expressions such as the following list of words because they “say” that something has already begun but is not finished.

so far

yet

up to now

for (time) [“For can be used with the simple past tense and the present perfect tense.”]

since

The following words do “say” that something is already finished, but they can be used in the present perfect because they “say” that the time was very close to the present time.

already

lately

recently

Examples of the last group:

I have already written most of this page. It has rained a lot recently. I have had headaches lately. Lately I have felt sick to my stomach. My son has recently bought a car.

Present Perfect Tense: Affirmative Form

I		gone
You	have	eaten
We		done
<u>They</u>		<u>played</u>
He		gone
She	has	eaten
It		done
		played

Examples:

I have been at school for two hours so far today. (I got here two hours ago and I am still here now. I will continue to be here for about five more hours today.)

My son has lived in Japan since July 25, 2009. (He arrived in Japan on July 25, 2009. He is in Japan now. I don’t know how long he will remain in Japan.)

My wife has taught cooking classes in Seattle since 1981. (She began teaching cooking classes in Seattle in 1981. She still teaches cooking classes in Seattle. I don’t know when she will stop teaching cooking classes in Seattle.)

Hopefully, you have learned a lot of English grammar so far. (You began studying in the past. You are still studying grammar but need to study more. Some day you will finish.)

The weather has recently gotten better in Seattle. (The weather was very bad in January and February. March was a little warmer. In April, May, and June, it will get even better.)

Present Perfect Tense: Negative Form

I		gone
You		eaten
We	haven’t	done
They		played
He	hasn’t	studied
She		shrunk

It started

Examples:

I haven't seen my friend Bob in many years.

My son hasn't called home since last Wednesday.

The weather hasn't changed much yet.

We haven't finished studying the perfect tenses yet.

I haven't started working on my next book yet.

My sons haven't played with toys for a long time.

Present Perfect Tense: Yes/No Question Form

I **seen** that movie?

you **studied** French before?

Have we **followed** the directions correctly?

they **bought** any food this week?

he **decided** to go to college?

Has she **drunk** any coffee today?

it **begun** to rain yet?

Examples:

Has your friend come back from her vacation yet?

Have you ever seen a ghost?

Has the snow melted yet?

Have you already had dinner tonight?

Has the temperature reached 60 degrees yet this year?

Present Perfect Tense: Information Question (WH Question) Form

Who I taken -----?

What you watched -----?

Where **have** we played with ----?

When they shown-----?

Whose (noun) **has** he worn-----?

Which (noun) she gotten-----?

Whom it received -----?

How crept -----?

How many (noun) have/has

How much (noun) has

Examples:

Whom have you seen recently?

Where have you been for such a long time?

What has your mother cooked for dinner this evening?

How many times have you gone to the Space Needle in Seattle?

Which restaurant have you decided to go to this evening?

Whose pictures have you seen?

Who's taken your car without telling you?

Who's driven in a snow storm in the mountains?

How much has he paid for his new car?

Who has written all of these exercises?

Which friend has your son gone out with tonight?

Exercise 11: Change the following sentences from the simple present tense to the present perfect tense, please. Write complete sentences. You may also have to change the "time words." Use words such as *forever, always, for, since, all their lives*.

1. We eat our lunch every day.
2. My mother always cleans the house during the weekend.
3. Boys all over the world make a lot of noise.
4. Students write sentences every quarter.
5. My sister smokes a lot of cigarettes every day.
6. Old people shrink day by day.
7. Some people speak a lot of languages.
8. Writing these sentences takes a lot of time.
9. We always swim in the Atlantic Ocean.
10. Doing homework helps you to learn English.
11. I get tired from sitting in front of a computer for a long time.
12. I listen to music almost every evening.

Exercise 12: Change these sentences to the present perfect tense, please. Be care because you may also have to change the "time words." Write out the complete sentence.

1. I swam in the ocean two times last year.

2. I worked for many years overseas.
3. I saw my students many times last week.
4. My wife cooked dinner for us every night.
5. My son swept the floor last week.
6. We came to English classes last quarter.
7. Some boys caused trouble at school last week.
8. My mother washed our clothes every week.
9. Driving my car made me tired.
10. We listened to the news at noon every day last year.
11. My neighbor cleaned his yard last week.
12. I had a headache many times last month.

Exercise 13: Look at the following groups of sentences. Read them and then write them using the present perfect tense please.

1. I planted a garden the first year I came to Seattle.
I plant a garden every year without fail.
I will plant a garden next year.

-
2. I first taught school in 1966.
I teach school every year.
I will teach school for eight more years.

-
3. My wife began teaching cooking classes in Seattle in 1981.
She teaches cooking classes every year.
She will continue teaching cooking classes next year.

-
4. My son Alex started working in Japan three years ago.
He still works in Japan.
He will continue working in Japan until he goes back to university again.
-

5. We got our dog Rosie nine years ago.
She lives with us now. (Hint: Use either the verb have or live.)
She will live with us until she dies.

6. I first visited Italy in 1971.
I visited Italy in 1972, 2005, 2007, and 2010.
I will visit Italy again someday.

7. My sister began owning her hair dressing salon in 1989.
My sister owns the hair dressing salon now.

8. I had a beard when I went to college.
I have the beard now.

9. I bought my car four months ago.
I have my car now.
I will have my car until it stops running well.

10. I built my greenhouse a long time ago.
I use it every year to grow peppers in.
I will use my greenhouse for as long as I live in Seattle.

11. My son began writing music when he was six years old.
He studied music composition in university
He has a job as a music composer.
He will probably always write music for as long as he lives.

12. My wife speaks Indonesian.
She learned to speak Indonesian as a child.
She will know how to speak Indonesian all of her life.

13. I have a headache now.
I had a headache this morning when I woke up.
I will probably have a headache all day today.

14. We started studying English this quarter last month.
You take classes every day from Monday through Friday.
We still have many days to go before the quarter ends.

15. I never visited the North Pole.
I will never visit the North Pole.

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6.1: Present Perfect Continuous Explanation and Formation

Present Perfect Continuous Explanation and Formation

The present perfect continuous tense is basically the same as the present perfect tense. Both of them talk about actions that began in the past, continue in the present, and will continue in the future. The difference between them is that the present perfect continuous tense emphasizes that the action of the verb is “in progress” as the person is either writing or speaking. Notice the difference between the following sentences.

I have typed many exercises in my life.

I have been typing this exercise for 10 minutes.

I have listened to the radio thousands of times in my life.

I have been listening to the radio for 20 minutes.

It has always rained a lot in the Seattle area for thousands of years.

It has been raining all day today.

My son has studied Japanese ever since he was in middle school.

My son has been in his room all day today. He has been studying Japanese ever since he got up this morning.

Both sentences in each pair began in the past, continue in the present, and will continue into the future. However, the difference is that the second sentence in each pair was “in progress” as I wrote the sentence. That is the difference between the present perfect tense and the present perfect continuous tense.

Present Perfect Continuous Form

I		studying for three hours.
You		writing since noon time.
We	have been	sitting in this chair all afternoon long.
They		doing this outline for 40 minutes.
He		studying for three hours.
She	has been	writing a letter to her mother for 20 minutes.
It		sitting on the porch all day.

Notice that for the present perfect continuous, you must use either have or has AND been, plus the ing form of the verb.

Exercise 14: Write five sentences in the present perfect continuous, please.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

Exercise 15: Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the Present Perfect Continuous Tense, please.

1. My friend _____ (hold) his baby for 20 minutes.
2. My sister _____ (live) in Rhode Island for many years.
3. My sons _____ (play) video games all day long.

4. My neighbor is an astronomer and _____ (look) at stars all night long.
5. I _____ (drive) around Chinatown looking for a parking space for 10 minutes.
6. Microsoft _____ (sell) computer software since the early 1980s.
7. The students _____ (use) many books in the library for their research project all quarter long.
8. People _____ (record) their thoughts on paper for many centuries.
9. Scientists _____ (think about) going to Mars for a number of years.
10. You _____ (use) my handout in this class this quarter.

Exercise 16: Write five sentences telling me about five places you have visited, but don't tell me when you were there, please.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Now write the same sentences, only now tell me when you went to these places.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Now write five other pairs of sentences using the present perfect tense to introduce an action and then the simple past tense to say when it happened.

For example: I have worn this shirt all day today. I put in on at 6:10 AM.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Exercise 17: Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the past tense, please. (Remember that I am now 70 years old and I am not dead yet.)

I ----- (do) many things in my life. When I ----- (be) a boy, I ----- (do) all the things that normal kids still do today. For example, in summer I ----- (go) fishing almost every day. Besides fishing, I also ----- (play) baseball and ----- (ride) my bicycle every day. In winter, I ----- (put) my bicycle, baseball glove and swim suit away and ----- (take out) my sled and ice skates. Whenever it ----- (snow), my sister and I always ----- (get) dressed in our warm clothes and ----- (take) our sleds to the hills which ----- (be) near our house. We ----- (slide) down the hills all day long. Sometimes if it ----- (be) just very cold for a long time, we ----- (wait) for the ice on the pond in back of our house to freeze, and then we ----- (walk) down the hill to the pond and ----- (skate) until our mother ----- (call) us in for dinner.

I ----- (teach) many classes at this college for many years. When I first ----- (start) here, I usually ----- (teach) low level classes because most of the students then ----- (not have) much experience with speaking English. Because I already ----- (have) a lot of experience teaching beginning English, the dean ----- (choose) me to teach those classes. It ----- (be) so much fun because the students ----- (work) so hard and ----- (make) good progress. Lately, however, I ----- (teach) higher level grammar because it ----- (be) also a lot of fun.

Exercise 18: Combine the following sentences or ideas by using the present perfect continuous tense, please.

1. The men are building a fence now. They started building the fence early this morning.
2. My wife is preparing for a party at our house tomorrow. She started preparing for the party yesterday.
3. My sons and I are trying to decide on which restaurant to go to for Mother's Day. We started talking about this last week.
4. I started writing this exercise about ten minutes ago.
5. The sun is shining today. In fact, the sun was shining on Friday and Saturday, and Sunday, too.
6. I am listening to some music as I write this exercise. It started playing about two minutes ago.
7. I put on a short sleeved shirt this morning. I am still wearing it right now. I won't take it off until I get home this afternoon.
8. My friend and his wife always argue. Last week they were arguing about where to go during summer vacation. They are still arguing about it today.
9. A baby is crying in another room. She started crying about ten minutes ago.
10. I started teaching at this college in 1981. I am still teaching here now.

11. The boys outside are playing a game of baseball. They started playing about two hours ago.
12. I am typing this exercise. I started it 15 minutes ago.
13. My son is living in Japan. He started living there in July 2009.

Exercise 19: Answer the following questions, please. Use either the present perfect tense or the present perfect continuous tense. Don't forget that the present perfect continuous tense is used when an action is in progress when the person speaks.

1. How long have you been studying in ESL in this class?
2. Have you ever driven a big truck?
3. How many questions have I written so far?
4. Where have you been sitting while doing this exercise?
5. Where have you usually sat when you studied?
6. What have you been wearing today?
7. Have you worn traditional clothes this week?
8. Has it been raining much in Seattle this week?
9. How many times have you flown in an airplane?
10. Have you ever ridden on an elephant?
11. Have you studied anything besides English this quarter?
12. Has the price of gas been going up or going down recently?
13. Has the radio been playing while you have been doing this exercise?
14. Whom have you loved all of your life?

Exercise 20: In the following sentences, choose between the simple past tense and the present perfect tense, please.

1. My wife and sons (come) ----- into the room while I was studying last night.
2. When we first (get) ----- married, my wife (shrink) ----- a sweater of mine when she (wash) -----
----- it in hot water.

3. My son Alex (be) ----- in university in 2003.
4. I (want) ----- to write an exam earlier in the week, but I (forget) -----to do it.
5. My friend (give) ----- me my car just before she (die) ----- last year, and I (drive) ----- it since then.
6. My students (not enjoy) ----- taking tests for as long as I can remember.
7. Many bombs (burst) ----- all around the world since the 20th century.
8. The shirt which I (buy) ----- yesterday (cost) ----- \$25.00.
9. Since the beginning of time, men (fight) ----- in wars.
10. Once when my kids were young, they (hide) ----- my car keys.
11. Last night my son (sweep) ----- the floors in my house.
12. I have a friend who (be) ----- out of work for six months even though he (seek) ----- many jobs in that time. (Two possible answers)
13. My wife (need) ----- some money, so she (withdraw) ----- \$200 from the bank last Friday.
14. I (write) ----- many exams in the last 41 years. I wonder when I will be finished.
15. When I (be) ----- in college for my BA degree, I (study) ----- history as my major.
16. I (wear) ----- a tie to school every day this quarter.
17. My wife, as always, (prepare) ----- a wonderful meal last night.
18. You (finish) ----- answering 18 questions so far.
19. You (finish) ----- answering 18 questions less than a minute ago.

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6.1.1: Present Perfect Tense Writing Passages

Present Perfect Tense Writing Passages

My Childhood Life

I have had an exciting, interesting, and fun life. I was born in Central Falls, Rhode Island, but I grew up in South Attleboro, Massachusetts. My family was poor, but I never realized it at the time because most of the people around us were poor. However, growing up for me was a lot of fun. South Attleboro was a very rural town. As a result, my family lived a rural lifestyle. We had lots of chickens, ducks, rabbits, dogs and cats. One of my chores was to feed and take care of the animals every day. I had to feed them, collect the eggs, and make sure that their cages were clean and that they had enough water. I also had to make sure that their cages were in good repair; otherwise, the rats, skunks, raccoons, and foxes would get into them and eat the animals. I loved this job because I liked being with the animals. Our house was located in the woods very near a big pond. There were also a lot of smaller ponds close to our house. As a result, every summer I would go swimming or fishing in the pond. Sometimes I fished from the shore, and other times I used a row boat. When I wasn't fishing or swimming, I was playing in the woods. It was such good fun to roam around the woods. In winter I would go ice skating or ice fishing on the pond. Across the street from my house there was an open field where my friends and I would play baseball or football. Thus, I had everything a young boy could ever want to occupy my free time and have a lot of fun.

My Life as a Young Man

I have had an exciting, interesting, and fun life. As soon as I graduated from college, I was drafted into the U. S. Army. I could have gotten out of my military service if I had decided to become a teacher right away after college, but I wanted to experience life before becoming a worker. I knew that being in a war would be interesting. Of course, I knew that it would be dangerous also, but I was young and as with most other young men, I knew that I could never get hurt or killed because I just knew it! Was I stupid? Of course, but I was young and young men never expect themselves to be in danger. I went off to war in Vietnam in October 1968 in a mechanized infantry unit. Was it dangerous? Yes, very! Was it exciting? Yes, sometimes too exciting! Was it interesting? Yes! Was it fun? Not really! Did I learn a lot? Very much: some good, some bad. After the army, I joined the U. S. Peace Corps. I was a volunteer in Tunisia in North Africa. Before reporting to Tunisia, I spent six weeks in the mountains of Colorado in training. Then I spent three weeks in England at Essex University in training. Then I spent three more weeks at a Tunisian resort in training. Needless to say, the training was great. I had a wonderful time. After the training, I was assigned to go to Gabes, Tunisia, a small oasis town located right on the Mediterranean sea coast. It was beautiful. I taught English as a foreign language there for two years. During the summer vacation in 1972, I went to the University of Aix-en-Provence to study French. I then toured around southern Europe for a month or so. When I finished with my two years, I spent six months hanging out in southern Europe again. Was it exciting, interesting and fun? You bet it was. After I got back to America in 1974, I decided I wanted to leave the country again, so I got a job in Iran, again teaching English as a foreign language. I spent two years in Iran, and it was even more interesting, exciting, and fun than Tunisia was. After I finished working in Iran, I took a two-and-a-half year vacation. I spent all of the money I had made in Iran and traveled all over Asia. It was fantastic, an absolutely fantastic time in my life.

My Life Today

I have had an exciting, interesting, and fun life. I have a great job teaching foreign students every day except Fridays, Saturdays, and Sundays. My students are the best in the world. They come to class prepared and anxious to learn. In addition, they are polite and hard working. Other than my teaching duties, I have to serve on various committees, most of which concern other instructors and instruction at the college as well as curriculum decisions. My home life is also quite nice. My sons have graduated from universities and are happily working and well-adjusted in life. Therefore, my wife and I have an empty nest, which is both good and bad. Without our sons in our house, all of our bills, especially food bills, are much less; thus, we are able to save more money for my retirement. However, I miss having my sons around. I love being a dad and hanging out with them, talking, joking, and teaching them. It's too quiet now that they are gone. Because I don't work during the summer, my wife and I have been able in recent years to take long, interesting, and relaxing vacations. Moreover, I can spend more time in my garden and on other projects around my house. In sum, I have a good life as my aging years pass by. I have no complaints at all.

My Life in the Future

I have had an exciting, interesting, and fun life. Barring injury or illness, my life should continue in this same manner. When I retire, I will spend more time gardening, working with wood projects, reading, and taking care of grandchildren – when and if my

sons get married and make my life-long dream come true: to be a grandfather. Ever since I was a young man, I have wanted to become a grandfather. It has always seemed like the best “job” in the world to me. I know I will teach and spoil my grandkids. If I have a granddaughter, I will be wrapped around her little finger. As I get older, I know more and more that this will be the case. I will also probably volunteer at a college or high school as a writing tutor. I have a lot of skill and knowledge about teaching foreign-born students, and I want to continue giving to students the benefit of my knowledge and experience. Thus, I look forward to being retired. It will be an enjoyable part of my life.

My Life

I have had an exciting, interesting, and fun life. I was born in Central Falls, Rhode Island, in an elevator. Thus, from the beginning I wanted to have an exciting, interesting, and fun time. Growing up, my family was poor in money but rich in culture and love. I never realized we were poor until I became a man. We moved to Massachusetts from Rhode Island when I was six years old. I am very happy that my parents decided to do that because we lived in the countryside with thousands of trees around us with four ponds in walking distance from my house, and a vacant lot across the street. It was the perfect place for a boy to grow up. I had lots of animals to take care of, wild places to play in and explore, ponds to swim in and ice skate on, and a field to play sports in. I wish my sons could have had the same environment to grow up in, but they are city boys. As I got older, I went to college, served in the U. S. Army and the U. S. Peace Corps, and traveled around the world twice. After that, I got married, had two children, and spent years raising them. Now I am a teacher in a community college where my students provide me with the pleasure of teaching them and watching them become more knowledgeable about English as well as American society. It is an incredibly rewarding job. Now, however, after 41 years, I am getting ready to retire. I will teach until I am 68 years old and then hang up my career. I will spend more time around the house doing gardening, working on wood projects, reading, and just enjoying myself. Hopefully, my sons will provide me with grandchildren and then my time will be devoted to them. I will come full circle from a baby born in an elevator to a granddad helping to raise the offspring of my offspring. Thus, I have had a great life and have no complaints at all. I have always been lucky.

Past Perfect Tense: Used to describe **two** related actions or activities that happened **at different times** in the past. Its emphasis is on showing the relationship of the actions relative to which one happened first and which one happened second. **The past perfect is used with the action that happened first; the simple past tense is used with the action that happened second.** It simply says, “First this thing had begun and ended, and then this other thing began and ended.” **Note:** Most native speakers tend not to use the past perfect. It can be avoided simply by using words such as *before*, *after*, *first*, *then*, *next*, *afterwards*, etc. and using the simple past tense to express **both** actions. Also, if something logically comes before something else, then native speakers avoid using the past perfect. It is not necessary.

Examples:

We **had finished** dinner when our friends **stopped by** for a visit.

My wife **had graduated** from the university when we **met** in 1979.

The students **had taken** the ESL Compass test when they **received** permission to register for class.

I **had taken out** the trash by the time my wife **returned** home from shopping.

I **had finished** university when I **went** into the army.

The students **had finished** the examination when John **arrived** in the room.

More on the Past Perfect Tense and the Past Continuous Tense

As I said above, the past perfect tense is used when two or more actions happened in the past **at different times**. One action began and ended in the past before another action began and ended in the past **at a different time**. The action further in the past (the action that happened first) uses the **past perfect tense**. The action that happened second uses the **simple past tense**. **Be careful not to confuse the past perfect tense with the past continuous tense.** The past continuous tense is used to describe two related actions or activities that happened in the past **at the same time**. Its emphasis is on showing the relationship of the actions relative to the duration of time each takes. The action of longer duration uses the past continuous tense; the action of shorter duration takes the simple past tense. It simply says, “While this **was happening**, something else **happened**.” The second action interrupts the first action that is already happening. The past continuous tense: two actions **at the same time**; the past perfect tense: two actions **at different times**.

Also, do not use the past perfect tense when talking about only one action.

Moreover, don’t use the past perfect if one action of naturally occurs before another action.

Examples:

I **had graduated** from university when I **was drafted** into the US Army.

After I **graduated** from university, I **was drafted** into the US Army.

I **had taught** for four hours by the time I **went** home.

After I **taught** for four hours, I **went** home.

I **had prepared** dinner when I **started** working on this handout.

Before I **started** working on this handout, I **prepared** dinner.

At the time I **went** shopping, I **had already put** gas in my car.

I **put** gas in my car. *After that*, I **went** shopping.

I **had defrosted** the beef when I **started** cutting up the vegetables.

First, I **defrosted** the beef. *Next*, I **cut up** the vegetables.

In the following sentences, I would not normally use the past perfect tense because it is not necessary. Of course the first action happened first.

I **had talked** to my mother, and then she **died**. I **talked** to my mother the day *before* she **died**.

Someone **had started** the fire, and the house **burned down**.

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6.1.1.1: Past Perfect Tense Form

Past Perfect Tense Form

I		
You		played
We		eaten
They	had	started
He		come
She		
It		

First one action began and finished. I got dressed.

Next, another action began and finished. I drank two cups of coffee.

Thus: I **had gotten** dressed by the time I **drank** two cups of coffee.

First one action began and finished. I graduated from college.

Next, another action began and finished. I went into the U. S. Army.

Thus: I **had graduated** from college when I **went** into the U. S. Army.

First one action began and finished. I worked all day.

Next, another action began and finished. I ate dinner with my family.

Thus: I **had worked** all day when I **ate** dinner with my family.

Past Perfect Continuous Tense: Like the non-continuous past perfect, the past perfect continuous tense is used for two actions in the past at different times. However, when using the past perfect continuous tense, the first action occurs **just before the second action begins**. **The first action takes the past perfect continuous tense and the second action takes the simple past tense.**

Examples:

*We **had been cleaning** the house for two hours when the children **came** home.*

*I **had been driving** for three hours when I **stopped** to fill up the tank with gas.*

*I **had been searching** for 20 minutes when suddenly I **saw** the book I **had been looking** for.*

*It **had been raining** steadily for two days when all of a sudden the sun **came** out.*

*The boys **had been talking** in their room when they **fell** asleep.*

First, one action was in progress in the past.

My wife **was washing** the kitchen floor.

Next, immediately another action happened in the past.

My son **walked** on the wet floor with his dirty shoes.

Thus:

My wife **had been washing** the floor when my son **walked** on it with his dirty shoes.

First, I **was driving** home from school.

Next, all of a sudden I **remembered** I forgot something important at school.

Thus, I **had been driving** home from school when I **remembered** I **had forgotten** something important at school.

It is important to remember that native speakers rarely use the past perfect tense or the past perfect continuous tense because it is much easier to use time words such as *before, after, next, then, etc.* These words eliminate the need for the past perfect tense.

Please note that there are other uses for the past perfect tense when it is absolutely necessary to use the past perfect. For untrue or unreal past conditional/hypothetical sentences and for reported speech in the past time, the past perfect is necessary. (You will study these later on in advanced grammar. They are difficult.)

Exercise 21: Combine the following sentences into one past perfect sentence, please.

Example:

John studied very hard for the test. He got 100 % on the test.

John had studied very hard, and he got 100 % on the exam.

1. Pedro played soccer all afternoon long. He felt very tired that night.
2. My sons and I walked in the forest for four hours. We decided to take a rest.
3. My son practiced the piece of music for many days. He won the piano contest.
4. I worked for two years in Iran. I took a two-year vacation.
5. My friend was in a hurry to get downtown. He waited for the bus for over an hour, but it never came. Finally, he took a taxi.
6. My son saved his money for two years. He bought a plane ticket to Japan.
7. I slept for 10 hours on Saturday night. I felt very good on Sunday.
8. My wife packed our suitcases. We left on vacation two days later.
9. I wrote a letter. I mailed the letter that afternoon at the post office.
10. My wife cooked dinner on Saturday. We ate the dinner on Sunday evening.
11. I studied in college for four years. I got my BA degree.

Exercise 22: Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb, please.

1. My sister ----- (take care of) my brother for many years. He's dead now.
2. I ----- (brush) my teeth before my son ----- (wake up) today.
3. While my son ----- (play) the piano, my wife ----- (tell) him to clean up his room.
4. My wife ----- (need) to sharpen one of her knives last night.
5. Although I ----- (eat) breakfast yesterday, I ----- (feel) hungry later.
6. I ----- (not smoke) cigarettes as a young boy.
7. My car----- (break down) on my way to school today, so I ----- (need) to call Triple A to get it ----- (start) again.
8. While a girl ----- (look) at an apple, it ----- (fall) to the ground.
9. The boys ----- (finish) their homework, by the time their father ----- (get) home from work.
10. My wife ----- (make) dinner for our family many times.
11. My grandfather, who died many years ago, ----- (plant) a garden every year in his back yard.
12. I ----- (never smoke) in my life.
13. While he ----- (lie) on the grass, my dog ----- (jump) on him.
14. Your teacher ----- (write) this exercise for 10 minutes.
15. My car ----- (run out of) gas on the way to school, and it ----- (stop) on the highway.

16. My friend ----- (drink) a lot of alcohol, and he ----- (fall) asleep on the living room floor.
17. My wife ----- (take) out the garbage last Wednesday morning.
18. My wife ----- (have) two babies, but my mother ----- (have) three babies.
19. The weather ----- (be) nice lately.

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6.1.1.1.1: The Future Perfect Tense

The Future Perfect Tense

The future perfect tense is used to describe two actions that will happen in the future **at different times**. The action closest to the present uses the **future perfect tense**. The action that happens at some time after the first action uses the **simple present tense**. (The future perfect tense is the least used verb tense by native speakers. It is unnecessary to use.)

Examples:

I **will have taught** ESL for over forty four years by the time I **retire**.

My sons **will have gotten married** before I **die**, hopefully.

My wife **will have prepared** dinner for my family by the time I **get** home this afternoon.

When you **get** to class tomorrow, you **will have written** five sentences for homework using the future perfect tense.

Future Perfect Form

I	I
You	you
We	we
They	they
He	he
She	she
It	it

will have past participle **simple present tense**.

Exercise 23: Combine the following sentences using the future perfect tense, please.

1. I will eat dinner. I will teach for six hours today.
2. My niece will graduate from high school. She will go to college in the fall.
3. We will enjoy the warm weather during the summer. The cold rainy weather will arrive in the fall.
4. Fall quarter will begin in September. We will enjoy not having classes.
5. My garden will produce many beautiful flowers and wonderful vegetables. The weather will get wet and cold and my flowers and vegetables will die.
6. You will finish this lesson soon. Some of you will start the next lesson right away.
7. I will write three more class booklets during the summer. Classes will begin in September.
8. My son will power wash our patio. Our friends will arrive from Japan this summer.
9. You will come to class tomorrow. You will do your homework tonight.
10. We will all sleep tonight. We will come to class in the morning.

Exercise 24: Write ten sentences using the future perfect tense, please.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.
- 8.
- 9.

10.

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7: Gerunds and Infinitives

Gerunds and Infinitives

I. Basic Ideas and Principles

A gerund is the *ing* form of the verb (present participle) used as a noun. Therefore, it can occur in all the same places that a noun can occur in a sentence: subject, object, complement, object of a preposition and appositive. **Please note: when a preposition is followed by a verb, that verb must always be in the form of a gerund**

An infinitive is the *base form of the verb* with *to* in front of it. For example, *to go, to run, to die, to love*, etc. are infinitives. Like a gerund, an infinitive too can also be used as a noun. **However, unlike a gerund an infinitive can never be used as the object of a preposition.** On the other hand, it can be used in places that neither a noun nor a gerund can be used: as an adverbial or an adverbial modifier. Thus, infinitives are used as subjects, objects, complements, appositives, adverbials and adjective modifiers.

II. Gerunds

I. The following verbs **take a gerund after them**. The ones with an * next to them can also take an infinitive after them with no change in meaning.

admit	advise	allow	avoid	* begin	consider
* continue	can't help	complete	defer	delay	deny
* deserve	dislike	enjoy	finish	forget	* hate
imagine	* like	* love	miss	permit	postpone
propose	* prefer quit	regret	remember	* start	
stop	suggest	* try	take turns	*take time	resent
acknowledge	justify	report	facilitate	anticipate	mention

Examples:

I dislike **working** on Sundays.

He missed **seeing** his father every day.

She can't help **being** sick.

I began **going** to school when I was six years old. / I began to go to school

They loved **eating** pizza every Friday evening. / They loved to eat pizza

III. Possessive Gerunds

The following verbs can take a possessive noun or a possessive adjective after them and before a gerund. **This is especially true in formal grammar. In informal grammar, native speakers tend to use regular nouns and objective pronouns.**

advise	appreciate	enjoy	excuse	defend	finish
forget	forbid	hate	imagine	like	dislike
love	permit	postpone	prefer	understand	suggest
regret	remember	consider	facilitate	mention	regret

The possessive adjectives are the following: my, your, his, her, its, our, your, their. They are always followed by a noun or a gerund.

Examples:

My books	my carrying books
Your music	your playing music
Their teacher	their teaching me

Possessive nouns end in an apostrophe s ('s) if the noun is singular or in an s apostrophe (s') if the noun is plural.

Examples: Singular Plural

The boy's father	the boys' father
The teacher's books	the teachers' books
My sister's dresses	My sisters' dresses

Form: Subject Verb Possessive Form Gerund Remainder of the Sentence

Examples:

I appreciate **your skipping** lines when you do your homework.
 He defended the **woman's killing** her husband because he had beaten her for many years.
 I suggest **your studying** hard for the exam next week.
 We regretted **their not being** able to come to the party.
 She hated **Bob's hanging** around with those lazy boys.

IV. Gerunds after Prepositions

When a verb follows a preposition, the verb **must always be in the ing form of the verb**, in other words, **the present participle form**.

Examples:

I have always been interested **in studying** history all my life.
 Many students are worried **about attending** regular classes with native English speakers.
 Teachers disapprove **of cheating** on exams and quizzes.
 Because **of cheating**, many students fail exams and compositions.
 In spite of losing the game, the players were still happy about playing.

Some verbs have two parts to them: the main verb part and a preposition after the verb. These are called two-word verbs. There are thousands of them in English. These two-word verb phrases are always followed by either a noun, a gerund, or some other noun form. If they are followed by a verb, it must be a gerund. Some common examples of two-word verbs are as follows:

to approve of	to care about	to take care of	to congratulate on
to decide between	to consist of	to dream about	to prevent from
to get used to	to have a reason for	to insist on	to look forward to
to decide on	to plan on	to waste money, time, or energy on	

In addition, there are very many passive adjective expressions which also end in a preposition.

to be afraid of	to be appropriate for	to be accustomed to	to be affected by
to be sure of	to be grateful to	to be worried about	to be willing to
to be sensitive to	to be tired of	to be interested in	to be concerned about

V. Infinitives

An infinitive is the *base form of the verb* with *to* in front of it. For example, *to go*, *to run*, *to die*, *to love*, etc. are infinitives. An infinitive can be used as a noun. Thus, infinitives are used as subjects, direct objects, complements, appositives, adverbials and adjective modifiers. **However, infinitives can never be used as the object of a preposition.**

The following verbs are followed by an infinitive:

Agree	Afford	Consent
Decide	Arrange	Decline
Expect	Attempt	Undertake
Hope	Deserve	Dread
Intend	Fail	Can't wait
Learn	Hesitate	Mean

Like	Manage	Commence
Need	Offer	Endeavor
Plan	Prepare	Proceed
Promise	Pretend	Strive
Try	Refuse	Seek
Want	Seem	Cease

Examples

I agreed to go to the party with my wife.

We plan to buy a new car next year.

The boy wants to stay overnight at his friend's house.

The teacher promised to give the students an examination next week.

My son refused to go to the University of Washington.

Children sometimes pretend to be sick when they don't want to go to school.

I hesitate to borrow anything from anybody.

Students need to manage to go to school, work, and take care of their families every day.

I can't afford to buy a new car. I don't have enough money.

Exercise 25: Answer the following questions by using a verb followed by an infinitive, please.

1. Why do you want to learn English?
2. Where do you intend to go after class today?
3. What kind of food do you like to eat?
4. What do you hesitate to do because you are afraid?
5. What do you seek to do in the next year?
6. Tell me something you can't wait to do.
7. What do little boys pretend to be?
8. What do you strive to do in your life all the time?
9. What do you need to do before you come to class tomorrow?
10. What can't you afford to buy before next year?
11. Where do you hope to live 10 years from now?
12. Tell me something you would refuse to do.

13. Tell me something that you try to do every day.

Exercise 26: Use the following words in good sentences, please.

1. to prepare

2. to intend

3. to decide

4. to dread

5. to refuse

6. to offer

7. to endeavor

8. to arrange

9. to attempt

10. to undertake

11. to seek

12. to agree

13. to hesitate

VI. Negative Infinitives

To make infinitives negative, put **not** before them.

Examples

The student promised not to come to class late anymore.

I preferred not to eat out in a restaurant.

The old man prefers not to drive at night.

The boy is planning not to go to college.

My sons often arrange not to be available when I need them to help me in the garden.

My son pretended not to feel well when my wife asked him to clean the bathrooms.

VII. Infinitives with Different Subjects

It is possible in a sentence to have the subject of the sentence be different from the subject of the infinitive. The following are some verbs that can take a different subject for the infinitive:

Would like	Persuade	Challenge
Expect	Get	Require
Tell	Force	Encourage
Advise	Help	Enable
Order	Permit	Direct
Urge	Invite	Prepare
Allow	Ask	Teach

Examples

I wanted André to go to the store for some milk.

We need Alex to lift up the heavy boxes.

I expected my students to do their homework every night.

I would like my friend to help me on Sunday.

The wife persuaded her husband to go to the doctor's.

The girl invited her friends to come to the party.

The teacher urged the students to study.

VIII. Infinitives with Adjectives before Them

Infinitives often follow adjectives. The infinitive is the complement of the adjective because the adjective needs the infinitive to give meaning to the adjective. Very often adjectives with infinitive complements follow sentences that begin with the expletive **It**. **It** has no meaning in these sentences; it is just serving as the subject of the sentence.

Examples

The English teacher was happy to help the student with her composition.

My wife was delighted to bake a birthday cake for our sons when they were boys.

It is difficult to learn English grammar.

All of the students were unhappy to hear the results of the examination.

My father was always willing to take all of my friends fishing when I was a boy.

I am content to continue to teach for a long time.

It is easy to ride a bicycle.

It is enjoyable to lie on a beach and do nothing.

It is impossible for a man to have a baby.

It is advisable to study before an examination.

It isn't smart to speed in a car on snow.

It is foolish to waste money on stupid things.

It is unethical to cheat on an examination.

IX. Infinitives with Adjectives and Too and Enough and Very

Too, *Enough* and *Very* are called **quantifiers** in grammar. *Too* means that something is excessive. It is negative in meaning. *Enough* means that something is sufficient. It is affirmative in meaning. *Very* only means to a high degree, "a lot." *Very* does not say either excessive or sufficient; it just says *a lot*. Many times people use the preposition *for* with these words.

Examples:

A new car is too expensive to buy. I can't buy one.

I am too old to play football. I can't play anymore.

To speak Chinese is too difficult for me to do. I can't do it.

My sister is too short to reach the shelves in the cupboard. She is only 5 feet tall.

It is too cold for people to go outside in winter. People don't want to go outside.

The hat is too small for my son to wear. He can't wear it. His head is too big.

I am old enough to be your grandfather. I am just waiting for my sons to become fathers.

Sixteen-year-old children are old enough to drive. They can drive legally.

My son is strong enough to lift 200 pounds. He is strong enough. He can do it.

This exercise is easy enough for my students to do. They can do it.

The weather in the summer is warm enough for people to go swimming in Green Lake. They can go swimming.

The girl is very beautiful. Men and women think she looks great.

My sister is very kind to animals and people. She is never mean or not nice to anyone.

Alaska is very cold in winter. Bears like it, but most people don't like living there.

New houses are very expensive to buy in the Seattle area. Only people with money can buy one.

Exercise 27: Answer the following question using a negative infinitive, please.

1. Tell me something you decided not to do.
2. Who do you not want to talk to?
3. Tell me a job you intend not to seek.
4. Tell me something you try not to do.
5. Tell me something you promised your mother not to do when you were a boy or girl.
6. What do you hope never to happen to you.
7. What will you need not to learn in your life?
8. What did you manage not to do last week?
9. Tell me something you decided not to buy.
10. What did you learn not to do when you were younger?
11. When did you mean not to say something?

12. What would parents not like their children to do?

13. What do you hope not to do again in the future?

Exercise 28: Answer the following questions with infinitives with different subjects, please.

1. What would you like me to do?
2. Who did you help to do something recently?
3. What did your parents permit you to do when you were younger?
4. What do I require you to do when you do homework for me?
5. What did your parents require you to do when you were younger?
6. What did you urge someone to do?
7. What do I allow you to do in my classroom?
8. Who persuaded you to come to America?
9. Who sometimes needs you to help them?
10. What do teachers expect their students to do?
11. What will learning English enable you to do?
12. What did your father permit you to do?
13. What is it sometimes difficult to get babies to do?

Exercise 29: Answer the following questions using an adjective followed by an infinitive, please.

1. Tell me something that is fun to do.
2. Tell me something that is difficult to do.
3. Tell me something that is enjoyable to do.

4. Tell me a game that is fun to play.
5. Tell me something that is not good to do.
6. Tell me something that is stupid to do.
7. Tell me something that is important to do.
8. Tell me something that is unlucky to do in your culture.
9. Tell me something that you are too old to do.
10. Tell me something that you are sometimes too tired to do.
11. Tell me something that is too expensive for you to buy.
12. Tell me something that is too difficult for old people to do.
13. Tell me something that is too heavy for you to lift.

X. Infinitives after Nouns

Infinitives sometimes follow nouns to express the purpose of the nouns.

Examples

I bought a new chair to sit on.

My friend uses a hose to water his garden.

I use an old knife to peel apples with.

My wife uses pots and pans to cook food in.

I have red pens to correct papers with.

He took out a handkerchief to blow his nose.

The policeman pulled out his gun to shoot the robber.

The violinist picked up his violin to play the musical piece he wrote.

XI. Verbs (*Forget, Remember, Stop, Quit*) that Have Different Meanings when Followed by a Gerund than when followed by an Infinitive

Forget + Infinitive: The forgetting occurs before the idea of the infinitive didn't happen.

Examples:

The man forgot to buy milk on his way home from work. [First, the man forgot, so he didn't buy the milk.]

I forgot to feed the dog. [First I forgot, so I didn't feed the dog.]

My sister forgot to send me a birthday card. [First she forgot, so she didn't send me a card.]

Forget + Gerund: The forgetting occurs after the idea of the gerund did happen.

Examples:

I forgot taking my medicine. [First I took the medicine, and then I forgot that I took it.]

The teacher forgot making copies of an assignment for his students. [First the teacher made the copies, and then he forgot that he had already made them.]

The old man forgot telling me the story. [First the old man told me the story, and then he told me the same story again because he didn't remember telling me the story before.]

Remember + Infinitive: Someone is telling the person not to forget to do something.

Examples:

I want my students to remember to study the past participles before the final exam. Don't forget to study them.

My son remembered to call home last night from Japan. He called home around 11:00 PM last night. He didn't forget to call home.

Remember + Gerund: The remembering takes place after the action of the gerund. It means not forgetting that you did something.

Examples:

I remember sending her a birthday day card. I sent the card and I remember that I sent it.

I remember going fishing with my father when I was a boy. I remember that we went fishing. I won't ever forget that we went fishing together.

When I was with my sister last summer, we were talking about old times. We both remembered my having to go to her kindergarten class to sit with her because she was afraid and crying.

Stop + Infinitive: The stopping of one action takes place before another action happens.

Examples:

While the man was driving home from work, he stopped to buy some milk at Safeway.

The boy was playing a video game, but he stopped [playing the video game] to eat dinner with his family.

While the young men were sitting and talking in a café, they stopped to look at a pretty girl who was walking by the café window.

Stop + Gerund: The stopping of one action is complete at least for a short while.

Examples:

At the age of 35, my brother stopped smoking. He never smoked again.

I wish my students would stop making mistakes in grammar and writing.

The man's heart stopped beating when he died.

Quit + Infinitive: The quitting of one action takes place before another action happens.

Examples:

The boy quit (school) to take a job.

The men quit working for fifteen minutes to take a break.

The students were arguing. They quit arguing when the teacher came into the room.

Quit + Gerund: The quitting of one action is complete at least for a short while.

Examples:

The man's wife quit complaining about his being a couch potato.

I quit trying to learn Portuguese.

It quit raining in Seattle last week.

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8: The Comparative of Equals

The Comparative of Equals

Vocabulary:

The same as is used with nouns when all of one noun is equal to all of another noun.

Examples:

My 1999 Ford Taurus was **the same as** my friend's 1999 Ford Taurus.

My first language is **the same as** my sister's first language.

One orange looks **the same as** another orange to me.

The same XXX as is used with nouns when one part of a noun is the same as one part of another noun.

Examples:

I teach in **the same** college **as** Kris and Allan.

Americans speak **the same** language **as** Australians do.

My sister has **the same** personality **as** I have.

Different from (than) is used when all of one noun is different from all of another noun.

Examples:

America is **different from** Vietnam.

Boys are **different from** girls.

Very rich people's lives are **different from** very poor people's lives.

A different XXX from (than) is used with nouns when only one part of nouns are different from each other.

Examples:

English has a **different** alphabet **from** Japanese.

My sons' hair is a **different** color **from** my wife's hair.

An apple has a **different** taste **than** an orange has.

As XXX as is used with adjectives and adverbs to show that part of one noun or verb is the same as part of another noun or verb. To show inequality, make the verb negative.

Examples:

I am **as** old **as** my friend Doug. We are both 70 years old.

Smoking is **as** bad for a person **as** drinking alcohol is.

I don't drive my car **as** rapidly **as** my sister drives her car.

Young people don't usually drive **as** slowly **as** old people do.

Exercise 34: Combine the following sentences into one sentence, using either *the same as* or *different from*, please. (Remember to use the negative verb to show differences.)

Examples:

My classroom and your classroom are the same. There is no difference.

My classroom is **the same as** your classroom.

My hat is size 7 and 1/4 and black. Your hat is size 8 and brown.

My hat is **different from** your hat.

1. My red pen and Roger's red pen are the same.
2. My library of English books is large. Your library of English books is small.
3. My book is red. Your book is blue.

4. Five times ten equals 50. Twenty-five times two equals 50.
5. I am fat and usually very happy. Roger is skinny and often unhappy.
6. My address is 9548 Phinney Ave. N. My sons' address is 9548 Phinney Ave. N.
7. My sister's house is one story and brown. My house is two stories and blue.
8. My friend Ed has a red Fit for a car. My friend Doug has a red Kit for a car.
9. Seattle's weather is usually cold and wet. Portland's weather is usually cold and wet.
10. My work schedule is day shift. My friend's work schedule is swing shift.
11. I am bald headed. My sons have beautiful hair.
12. My sons are tall. I am short.

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8.1: Nouns and Corresponding Adjectives

Nouns and Corresponding Adjectives

<u>Nouns</u>	<u>Adjectives</u>
Size	big / small large / little
Length	long / short
Width	wide / narrow
Height (people)	tall / short
Height (things)	high / low
Weight	heavy / light
Depth	deep / shallow
Thickness	thick / thin
Hardness	hard / soft
Age (people)	old / young
Age (things)	old / new
Speed	fast / slow
Color	light / dark
Price	expensive / inexpensive cheap
Distance	far from / near to close
Taste	good / bad sweet / sour spicy / bland hot / mild
Health	healthy / unhealthy well / sick

Exercise 35: Rewrite the following sentences using as XXX as, please.

1. My car is the same length as my friend's car.
2. Most streets are the same width as each other in Seattle.
3. Each book for this class is the same thickness as the others.
4. The college is the same distance from my house as it is from my friend Sara's house.
5. One orange chair is the same weight as the other orange chairs.

6. My son Alex is the same height as my son André.
7. My office is the same size as my friend Roger's office.
8. My table is the same height as your table.
9. One swimming pool is the same depth as another swimming pool.
10. Seattle and Portland are about the same size.
11. My friend Roger's hair is the same length as my friend Doug's hair.
12. The Space Needle is the same height as some office buildings in downtown Seattle.
13. My cat's fur is soft. My friend's cat fur is soft.
14. I run slowly. My friend runs slowly.
15. My sister is 5 feet tall. My mother was 5 feet tall.

The expression **as XXX as** can also be used with quantity expressions such as *many, much, few, and little*.

Examples:

I bought three books. My friend bought three books.

I bought as many books as my friend did.

I ate two cheeseburgers. My son ate two cheeseburgers.

I ate as much food as my son did. I ate as many cheeseburgers as my son did.

I have two pens. My friend has two pens.

I have as few pens as my friend has.

I only have two dollars. My sister only has two dollars.

I have as little money as my sister does.

Exercise 36: Combine the following sentences using as XXX as, please.

1. My sister has five dogs. My friend has five dogs.
2. I drank a lot of water. My friend drank a lot of water.
3. It rains a lot in Seattle. It rains about the same in Portland.
4. My son Alex bought two shirts. My son André bought two shirts.
5. I have 30 students. Sara has 30 students.

6. I ate a dish of ice cream. My son ate a dish of ice cream.
7. I read 100 pages of a book over the weekend. My friend read 100 pages of the same book over the weekend.
8. You had a lot of homework. My other class had the same amount of homework.
9. The temperature was 45 degrees today. It was the same temperature yesterday.

Exercise 37: Combine the following sentences using not as XXX as, please.

Examples:

I speak clearly. My son Alex doesn't speak clearly.

My son Alex doesn't speak as clearly as I do.

I sing well. My son André doesn't sing well.

My son André doesn't sing as well as I sing.

1. My wife walks slowly. I don't walk slowly.
2. Some students work carefully. Other students don't work carefully.
3. Old people drive attentively. Young people don't drive attentively.
4. My elder son eats very quickly. My younger son eats very slowly.
5. Good students react obediently to teachers. Bad students react poorly to teachers.
6. Some students write legibly. Other students don't write legibly.
7. My friend speaks sarcastically. Another friend doesn't speak sarcastically.
8. My son reads fast in Japanese. He doesn't read fast in English.
9. My sons swim very fast. I swim slowly.
10. I can do mathematics quite accurately. My wife makes many mistakes in math.
11. Athletes move gracefully. I move awkwardly.
12. My wife cooks very well. My younger son cooks very poorly.

Exercise 38: Combine these sentences with either the same XXX as, different from, or as XXX as, please.

Examples:

My shoes are brown. Your shoes are brown.
Your shoes are the same color as mine.

The history of France is interesting. The history of Iran is interesting.
The history of France is as interesting as the history of Iran.

1. My sister speaks clearly. I speak clearly.
2. My shoes are size 8. My wife's shoes are size 8.
3. My son Alex cleans the house poorly. My son André cleans the house poorly.
4. Alex's age is 30. André's age is 28.
5. My dog is quite beautiful. My friend's dog is also quite beautiful.
6. My car cost \$3,200. My friend's car cost \$5,280.
7. My friend's garden is beautiful. My garden is beautiful.
8. Roger speaks very good French. I speak OK French.
9. The quality of my sweater is very good. The quality of my friend's sweater is also very good.
10. This exercise is very difficult. The last exercise was very easy.
11. Vegetables are good for your health. Candy is not good for your health.
12. I am 5 feet 7 ½ inches tall. Ed is 5 feet 8 inches tall.

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8.1.1: The Comparative and Superlative with Quantity Expressions

The Comparative and Superlative with Quantity Expressions

Quantity expressions can also be used for the comparative and the superlative when speaking about adjectives, adverbs, and nouns. Note below:

much	more	the most
many	more	the most
a lot of	more	the most
lots of	more	the most
a little	less	the least
a few	fewer	the fewest

NOTE:

Much, **a little**, and **the least** are used with non-count nouns.

Many, **a few**, and **the fewest** are used with count nouns.

Examples:

The first woman is organized. The second woman is more organized than the first woman. The third woman is the most organized of the three women.

The first woman is not very organized. The second woman is less organized than the first woman. The third woman is the least organized of the three women.

These examples are normal comparative and superlative of an adjective (organized).

With nouns it is a little more difficult, however.

Examples:

I have many friends. My sister has more friends than I have. My brother has the most friends.

I have lots of sheet music at home. My older son has more sheet music than I do. My younger has the most sheet music. In fact, my younger son has much more sheet music than my older son has. As well, I have the least sheet music of the three of us.

I don't have much money. My sister has less money than I have. My brother has the least money in our family.

I have some money. President Obama has more money than I have. Bill Gates has the most money in America.

I have a few problems in life. My friend Roger has fewer problems than I have. Our friend Doug has almost no problems. Doug has the fewest problems of the three of us.

I have a little hair. My nephew has less hair than I have. My Uncle Carl has the least hair in our family.

Exercise 39: Fill in the blanks with the appropriate word.

1. I have 200 books. Roger has 250. Roger has ----- than I have.
2. I spent three hours on my homework. André spent two hours on his homework. Alex spent one hour on his homework. Alex spent ----- time on his homework.
3. Mike has \$100. Roger has \$40. I have \$250. I have ----- money of the three of us.
4. I drank a lot of water, but Roger drank ----- water than I did.
5. I have a lot of clothes. André has less clothes than I have. Alex has ----- clothes of the three of us.

6. I weigh 201 pounds. André weighs 178 pounds. Alex weighs 250 pounds. Who weighs the most? ----- . Who weighs the least? -----
7. I have ----- hair than either of my sons. (FYI: I am bald.)
8. Boys make ----- noise than girls.
9. Students in lower levels have trouble with grammar. Students in intermediate levels usually have ----- trouble with grammar ----- students in lower level. Students in the highest level usually have ----- trouble with grammar of all.
10. I eat more fruit than my sons, but my wife eats ----- fruit in our family.
11. Level 2 English is ----- advanced ----- level 3 English. On the other hand, level 3 English is ----- difficult ----- level 2 English.
12. There is lots of water in lakes. There is much ----- water in oceans.
13. I have a few French books. My friend Angel has many ----- French books than I have.

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9: Modal Verbs

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9.1: Modal Verbs

Modal Verbs

Can	These are the eight modal verbs in English. They are helping verbs ; therefore, the negative and the question forms of sentences involve using them. They are always followed by the base form of the verb. After the modal verbs, there is always another verb, the main verb . Never use to between a modal and the main verb. Also, never add anything to the main verb. Never add s, es, ing, or ed . <u>Never add anything....</u>
Could	
Will	
Would	
May	
Might	
Should	
Must	

Examples

I can teach English.

In this sentence, the main verb is *teach*. The modal verb is *can*. *Teach* says what I do; *can* says that I have the ability to teach. Notice there is no change when I use *he*, *she*, or *it*.

He can teach English. She can teach English. It can teach English. Notice there is no *s* or *es* added to *teach*.

You must type your homework this weekend.

In this sentence, the main verb is *type* and the modal verb is *must*. *Type* says what you will do this weekend and *must* says that you have no choice but to do the work. It is an obligation. Notice that there is no **to** between *must* and *type*.

Common Mistakes

She should **to** make dinner for her family every night.

He must drives his mother to the store tonight

It might raining in New York now.

I could played baseball every day when I was a boy..

I would **ate** dinner with my mother and father every day.

The girl will **be** play with her friends after school tomorrow.

All of the above mistakes are wrong because they either add to between the modal verb and the main verb or because they add something to the end of the main verb.

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9.2: Modal Verb Formation and Structure

Modal Verb Formation and Structure

Modal Verbs are helping verbs. Therefore, both the negative form and the question form are made by using the modal verbs.

Affirmative Modals

I	would		go with my father.
You	can		play video games.
We	will		do our homework later on.
They	might	Base Form of the Verb	drink some tea.
He	should		study harder.
She	must		follow the rules.
It	may		decide to go.
You	could		see the moon better.

Negative Modals

I	can't		run very fast.
You	couldn't		jump high.
He	won't		fly to Boston next week.
She	wouldn't	Base Form of the Verb	report to class on time.
It	may not		take your time.
We	might not		smile at his jokes.
They	shouldn't		steal anything.
You	mustn't		copy someone else's homework.

Question Modals

May I		go home early with my friend?
Will you		come to school tomorrow?
Could she		ride a bicycle?
Would he	Base Form of the Verb	help you?
Can it		drive safely?
Might we		do our work later?
Should they		study harder?
Must you		leave so soon?

Information Questions (WH Questions) with Modal Verbs

Whom may I go home early with? (**Whom** replaces the object **my friend**.)

Where will you come tomorrow?

What could she ride?

Who would help you? (**Who** replaces the subject **he**.)

How can it drive?

When might we do our work?

How should they study?

When must you leave?

Simple Present and Future Tenses with Will and Other Modal and Quasi-Modal Verbs

I	might not come	to school next quarter.
He	ought to study	many more hours.
She	will study	next year.
It	will eat	tomorrow morning.
We	might watch	tomorrow night.
You	must study	in the library.
They	had better not cheat	on the exam.

The simple future tense is used for actions in the future. Besides “will,” all of the other modal verbs and quasi-modal verbs may be used with a future meaning.

Future and Present Continuous Tenses with Will and Modals and Quasi-Modal Verbs

I	will	be	sleeping at 2:00 AM tonight.
He	might	be	watching a movie with his girlfriend now.
She	should	be	studying tonight.
It	ought to	be	clearing up later on this evening.
We	must	be	doing grammar now.
You	may	be	visiting your grandmother next month.
They	have to	be	worrying about their sick child.

The present and future continuous with will and other modals stresses the on-going action of the modal in the present and future time.

The Future Continuous Tense and the Simple Future Tense

You **will be doing** some homework this evening.

You **will do** more homework in this class this quarter.

*My family and I **will be eating** dinner at 7:30 this evening.*

*My family and I **will eat** dinner at 7:30 this evening.*

The future continuous stresses the verb’s action being in progress at some time in the future. The simple future only says that something will happen in the future.

Note that in all of the examples above that the modal verbs are ALWAYS followed by the base form of the verb. With the continuous modals, that means that they are followed by the base form of the verb To Be: **be**. And because they are a continuous tense, it also means that the **ING** form of the verb must also be used.

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9.3: Modal Verb Form Errors Analysis and Structure Exercise

Modal Verb Form Errors Analysis and Structure Exercise

Exercise 38: Make all necessary corrections in verb forms in the sentences, please.

1. He musts goes to the doctor for the cut on his head.
2. We will going to the movie tonight with our friends.
3. I can't not go with you this evening to your brother's house.
4. Children should not be play with matches.
5. We was able to fix the flat tire on our car yesterday.
6. My big brother could ate a lot of food when he were a boy.
7. Tonight we are going to play Nintendo, and then we will be watch a video movie.
8. He might not sees the spider on his shirt.
9. I could be played football when I was a young man.
10. It may raining tonight.
11. His sister must goes to school every day next week.
12. The boys and their father would worked on the farm all day when they was younger.
13. He oughts to learns to fixes his car by himself in order to save some money.
14. We had to do a lot of homework tomorrow evening.
15. The company told the employees that they would be work overtime next week.
16. The boys is going to working on their homework later this evening.
17. He have to finishes his homework before he can goes to the party with his friends.
18. He must finishes his composition before he cans goes outside to play.
19. They will be study for their exam this weekend.
20. He must always eats all the food on his plate before he can leaves the table.
21. He should has finished his homework by now.

Modal and Quasi-Modal Verbs

Can	Ability to do something	Present or future
------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------

To be able to (am, is, are)	I can drive a car.
--	---------------------------

	My wife is able to drive a car.
--	--

Will / Won't (Will not)	Future action	Future
--------------------------------	----------------------	---------------

To be going to (am, is, are) (gonna)	I will help you clean your apartment.
	We are going to study tonight.

Will = Volunteer / Promise
Going to = Plans

Used to (useta)	Past situations; no longer exist; Past used by native speakers to
----------------------------------	--

**introduce repeated situations
in the past**

I **used to live** in Massachusetts.

I **used to travel** a lot.

Would

Repeated actions in the past

Past

I **used to live** with my parents. I **would eat** my mother's food every day.

I **would go** fishing with my father. I **would attend** school every day.

Could

Ability to do something

Past ability

**To be able to
(was, were)**

**For a single event in the past,
use was/were able to; for repeated
past events, use could.**

When I went to Victoria, I **was able to visit** Butchart Gardens.

When I was a boy, I **could play** baseball every day.

Would / Could

Polite requests

Present or future

Would you open the window for me?

Could you come at 3:00 instead of 4:00, please?

**Would rather ... than
'd rather ... than**

Preference

Present or future

I'd rather eat chicken than beef.

Would rather not do

She'd **rather not study** tonight.

May

**Permission
Possibility (50/50 chance)**

Present or future

You **may drink** coffee in class. I
give you permission.

It **may be** sunny next week. It's possible.

Might

Possibility (50/50 chance)

Present or future

We might go to a movie next Friday.
It's a possibility. Maybe we will and
maybe we won't.

**Should
Ought to
(ordda)**

**Obligation, desirability,
expectation**

Present or future

You **should stop** smoking in order to
keep your lungs in good condition. -- obligation

You **should teach** your children to speak
your native language. -- desirability

We **have got to clean** the house before our guests come.

My sister **has got to take** medicine three times a day.

**Had to
(hadda)**

Obligation or necessity in the past

**Past of must and
have to**

He **had to take** his daughter to the hospital last night because she had a high fever.

He **had to change** the flat tire on his car last night.

I **had to write** this handout for my students.

**Must not
(musement)**

Negative conclusion or prohibition

Present or future

You **must not drink and drive**.

You **must not use** bad language in class.

The girl won't eat. She **must not be** hungry.

Children **must not** play with matches and knives.

**Not have to
(not hafta)**

No obligation or necessity at all

**Present, past, or
future**

You **don't have to come** to school on Saturday.

When you lived with your mother, you **didn't have to cook**.

You **won't have to do** any homework during vacation.

I **didn't have to work** when I was a young boy.

I **won't have to come** to college during the summer.

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9.4: Sentence Formation with Present and Future Modal Exercises

Sentence Formation with Present and Future Modal Exercises

Exercise 39: In the following series of exercises, make sentences with the modal verbs at the top of each exercise and the verb phrase given, please.

A: Can or can not

1. I ----- eat 10 hamburgers.
2. My mother ----- cook better than I can.
3. Women ----- usually clean the house better than men can.
4. I ----- learn English.
5. With an education, people ----- earn more money than without an education.
6. Most people in this classroom ----- speak Chinese.
7. Because we come to class, we ----- sleep late in the morning.
8. My mother ----- speak English.
9. My father ----- drive a car.
10. My teacher ----- teach English.

B: Will or Won't

1. I ----- come to class tomorrow.
2. My teacher ----- wear jeans to class tomorrow.
3. Someone ----- open the door to this room tomorrow morning.
4. My teacher ----- correct my homework assignment tonight.
5. President Obama ----- teach this class tomorrow.
6. It ----- rain next week in Seattle.
7. It ----- be cold outside next August.
8. I ----- study hard in order to learn English.
9. I ----- buy a car next week.
10. We ----- see each other tomorrow morning.

C: Should or Should Not

1. Students ----- come to class every day and on time.
2. People ----- drink alcohol and drive their cars.
3. Everyone ----- eat healthy food.
4. No one ----- eat junk food every day.
5. Children ----- obey their parents and grandparents.
6. Students ----- skip lines in my class when doing homework.
7. Old people ----- be careful when walking on snow and ice.
8. Smoking is bad for the health, so people ----- smoke.
9. No one ----- play with guns and matches.
10. Everyone ----- be careful with guns and fire.

D: May, May Not or Might, Might Not

1. It ----- rain next week.
2. My son ----- call home next week.
3. I ----- eat in a restaurant tonight.
4. My students ----- have homework tomorrow.
5. We ----- have an exam next week.
6. The moon ----- be bright tonight.
7. My teacher ----- wear a tie to school tomorrow.
8. I ----- have to buy gas for my car tomorrow afternoon.
9. I bought a lottery ticket, so I ----- be a millionaire next week.
10. Some people ----- visit me this weekend.

E: Can or Could

1. I ----- play with my friends when I was a young child.
2. Some rich people ----- spend a lot of money and not worry about it.
3. My friends and I ----- spend a lot of time doing nothing a long time ago.
4. Young boys ----- make a lot of noise.
5. My mother ----- cook good Italian food when she was alive.
6. When I was a boy, I ----- help my grandparents around their house.
7. Every year your teacher ----- make a very nice garden.
8. Everyone wishes that they ----- do some things differently in their lives.
9. Both of my sons ----- play the piano.
10. When my sons were young, they ----- get into places free.

F: Must and Either Have To or Has To (First with “must,” then ‘have to’ or “has to.”)

1. Children ----- go to school, and they ----- study.
2. Today I ----- go to the market because I ----- buy some groceries.
3. My son ----- practice his piano because he ----- play at a wedding next week.
4. Mothers ----- take care of their children, and they ----- cook food for them.
5. My sister ----- take her husband to the doctor’s office, and then she ----- wait for him.
6. I ----- write my homework assignments and then my students ----- do them.
7. I have a problem with my car, so I ----- take it to a mechanic. He will ----- fix whatever is broken.
8. My student ----- get a haircut, and her hairdresser ----- cut it for her.
9. My sister and niece ----- prepare dinner for a party. Before they cook the food, they -----go shopping.
10. Every day I ----- assign homework to my students and then I ----- correct the homework assignments.
11. My son ----- (help out) around the house. For example, he ----- (mow) the lawn and take the dog for walks.

G: Would Rather and Had Better in the Negative (Put NOT after these two quasi-modals to make the negative. They are both either the present tense or the future tense; THEY ARE NOT THE PAST TENSE.)

Change these sentences to the negative, please. Write out the complete sentence. Don’t just write in the word not.

1. I would rather stay home this evening.

2. You had better come to class tomorrow.
3. My son would rather play the piano than the violin.
4. You had better continue taking that medicine.
5. Your teacher would rather wear a sweater than a tie.
6. You had better change your clothes when you go to work.
7. My son would rather eat hot peppers.
8. You had better drink coffee before you go to work.
9. I would rather sleep late in the morning.
10. We had better take our vacation soon.
11. The students had better go to the party.

Exercise 40: Answer the following questions, please.

1. Where might you be living when you are 65 years old?
2. What should you do every night?
3. Would you rather watch football on TV or watch a movie?
4. When had you better do this assignment?
5. How many languages can you speak?
6. What time will you go to bed this evening?
7. What have you got to do before you come back to this class next Friday?
8. How old will you be on your next birthday?
9. What do you have to do before you next Monday?
10. What had you better do before you take an examination?
11. Who could you play with when you were a child?
12. What may you do on Sunday morning?
13. When are you supposed to come back to school next?

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9.5: WH Questions with Modals

WH Questions with Modals

Exercise 41: Make questions with the WH words which follow the sentences, please.

1. I will buy a new car next year.
When
Who
2. I had to take some medicine last week.
When
What
3. We should study irregular verbs before we take the final exam.
What
When
4. You had better come to class on time on Friday.
Who
When
5. It might rain on Sunday.
When
6. You could have stayed at home today.
Where
When
7. My friend's children must have eaten dinner this evening.
Who
What
When

Exercise 42: Change the following sentences into WH (information) questions with the words under the sentences, please.

1. The boy is fishing in the lake.
Who
Where
2. My son was playing the piano in the living room.
Who
What
Where
3. We will be at the market this afternoon.
Who
Where
When
4. Fifteen dogs were chasing the cat.
What

How many

What

5. Someone is knocking on the classroom door.

Who

What

6. The box of chocolates is beside the lamp.

What

Where

7. Bob might be running in New York today.

Who

Where

When

8. The father was listening to his son's music last night.

Who

Whose

When

9. My sister will be showing the picture to her friends before dinner tonight.

Who

What

To whom

10. It must be raining in the mountains now.

Where

When

11. Those boys should be studying for their test and not playing video games.

What

Who

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9.6: Continuous Modal Verbs

Continuous Modal Verbs

All the modals can be used in the continuous (progressive) tense when they stress the idea that something is in progress (happening) at present (or in the future with "will"). They emphasize the action's being in progress at the time when the person is speaking.

As with all of the continuous tenses, the idea of the "ing" is to emphasize the action of the verb and its being in progress; the function of the modal is to influence the meaning of the verb.

The form of continuous modals is:

The modal + be + the verb + ing

Examples:

1. It **might be raining** in Japan right now.
2. You **should be paying attention** to me now and **not thinking** about your girlfriend.
3. It's 3:00 a.m. right now, so my sister **must be sleeping**.
4. At 7:00 p.m. tomorrow evening, I **will be eating** dinner with my family.
5. If today were Saturday, I **could be working** in my garden now.
6. I definitely **won't be correcting** homework papers on Saturday evening.
7. My wife **may be working** in her office now.
8. We **will be taking** an exam on Monday morning at 11:00 A.M.
9. My sons are in school now, so they **must be listening** to their teachers.
10. My son **might be sleeping** right now because he is in Japan.

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9.7: Continuous Modal Verb Exercise

Continuous Modal Verb Exercise

Exercise 43: Answer the following questions using continuous modals, please.

1. Where might you be living in the year 2020?
2. What will you be doing next Saturday afternoon?
3. What must most of the people in China be doing right now?
4. What should all of the students in this class be thinking about now?
5. When might the sun be shining continuously every day in Seattle?
6. What could you be doing right now if you weren't in school?
7. What might your relatives be doing in your home country right now?
8. What would you be doing if you were in your native country?
9. What might you be doing at this time a year from now?
10. When will you be sleeping next?
11. What may your best friend be doing right now?
12. How long will you be taking ESL classes?
13. When will you be watching television?
14. Who will be correcting your homework papers this evening?

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9.8: Past Modal Verbs Used in the Simple Past Time

Past Modal Verbs Used in the Simple Past Time

For Repeated Actions in the Past:

Used to, Could, and Would = Simple Past Tense

<u>Used to</u>	base form of the verb	Past situations; no longer exist; used by native speakers to introduce repeated situations in the past.	Past
----------------	--------------------------	--	------

*I **used to live** in Massachusetts.*

*My sister **used to go** fishing with my father and me.*

*I **used to travel** a lot.*

*I **used to be** a good walker.*

*I **used to go hunting** with my grandfather.*

*My sons **used to play** with toys.*

<u>Could</u>	base form of the verb	Ability to do something	Repeated past ability
--------------	--------------------------	-------------------------	-----------------------

To be able to (was, were)	For a single event in the past, use <u>was/were able to</u> ; for repeated past events, use <u>could</u> .
------------------------------	--

*When I **was** a young boy and I **visited** my grandparents, I **could** do almost anything I **wanted** to do. First of all, I **could walk** to my grandparents' house because we **lived** close to their house. I **could eat** whatever I **wanted** to eat because I **was** my grandmother's favorite grandchild. I **could watch** TV or I **could play with** my grandfather's hunting dogs. Sometimes I **could go** hunting for rabbits and birds with my grandfather and uncle, too. They **would let** me shoot their guns. My mother **would never let** me shoot guns.*

<u>Would</u>	Repeated actions in the past	Repeated past ability
--------------	------------------------------	-----------------------

*I **used to live** with my parents. I **would eat** my mother's food every day.*

*I **would go** fishing with my father. I **would go** to school every day. We **would all have fun** at home together. We **would always joke around** with each other. We **would laugh** a lot, too.*

Exercise 44: Answer the following questions using *used to*, *would*, or *could*, please.

1. At what time would you eat dinner when you were in your native country?
2. Who would prepare dinner for your family when you were a child?
3. What could you do as a child that you can't do now?
4. Who used to take care of you when you were very young?
5. Where would your mother go shopping a long time ago?
6. Who could you visit in your country that you can't visit anymore?
7. Who did you use to see every day when you were in your country?
8. Who would you play with when you were very young?
9. At what time would you wake up when you lived in your native country?
10. What kind of food would you eat as a child?
11. What sports could you play in your native country?

12. Who used to teach you when you lived with your parents?
 13. What would you do on most days when you were about 10 years old?
 14. Would you speak English with other people when you lived in your native country?
-

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9.9: Past Modals for Single Actions in the Past- The Simple Past Tense

Past Modals for Single Actions in the Past: The Simple Past Tense

The past tense of **must**, **have to**, and **has to** is **HAD TO**.

Had to (hadda)	Obligation or necessity in the past	Past of <u>must</u>, <u>have to</u>, and <u>has to</u>
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*He **had to take** his daughter to the hospital last night because she had a high fever.*
*He **had to change** the flat tire on his car last night.*
*We **had to pay** our income taxes last year before April 15th.*
*I **had to drive** my wife downtown because she is afraid to drive in the city by herself.*
*My son **had to memorize** a lot of music for his concert.*

Must have + past participle (musta)	Past conclusion or supposition only; <u>Never</u> a past obligation: For past obligations, use <u>had to</u>.
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*Sara is a teacher; therefore, she **must have graduated** from a four-year college. (conclusion)*
*There was some candy on the table and the children were in the room. Now the candy is gone. The children **must have eaten** the candy. (conclusion)*
*She broke her leg playing basketball. It **must have hurt** a lot. (conclusion)*
*When I came home last night, the house was very clean. My wife **must have done** a lot of housework during the day. (conclusion)*

However

*While I was driving home, I got a flat tire, so I **had to use** my spare tire. (obligation)*
*The boy cut his head badly, so he **had to go** to the hospital. (obligation)*
*The toilet broke last night, so I **had to fix** it right away. (obligation)*

Might have + past participle May have + past participle Could have + past participle (mighta, may, coulda)	Past situation -- maybe it happened, maybe it didn't. We don't know for sure, but we do know that it was possible.
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*The student didn't come to class yesterday. She **might have gone** to the doctor's. She **might have had** an accident. She **may have gone** shopping. She **could have stayed** in bed. I don't know what happened for sure, but all of the above are possible.*
*My friend bought a lottery ticket. He **could have had** the winning ticket. I don't know, but it is possible.*
*It **might have snowed** in the mountains last night. Then again, it **might not have snowed**.*
*My sons **might have seen** each other this past weekend, but I am not sure.*

Could have + past participle **Past ability or capability to do something, but you chose not to do it. You had the opportunity to do something, but you decided not to do it.**

A past possibility that you had an opportunity to do, but you chose not to do.

*I lived in Asia for over 5 and a half years, but I never went to Korea. I **could have gone** there many times, but never did.*
*I **could have stayed** in Europe in 1973, but I decided to return to the United States instead.*
*I **could have become** a history teacher if I had wanted to, but I decided to become an English teacher instead.*
*You **could have skipped** school today if you had wanted to, but you decided to come.*
*My wife and I **could have gone** to a movie last night, but we were too tired and decided to bag it and not go.*

Should have + past participle**Past obligation which you didn't**

do. Something was the correct or right action to do, but you didn't do it. Something was a good idea or thing to do in the past, but you didn't do it. In other words, you made a mistake.

*You were speeding in a car and a policeman saw you and gave you a speeding ticket. You **should have slowed down**, but you didn't.*

*You had a test last week, but you didn't study for it and you failed it. You **should have studied** for it, but you didn't.*

*My son went outside without his coat in the rain last week and he caught a bad cold. He **should have worn** a coat, but he didn't.*

*The students **shouldn't have cheated** on the exam, but they did.*

*I **should have learned** how to type when I was in high school, but I didn't. As a result, I am a slow typist.*

*America **shouldn't have gotten** into a war with Iraq, but it did.*

*Those boys **shouldn't have teased** the new student in the class. He started to cry and then everyone felt bad for him.*

Exercise 45: Change the following sentences to the past, using "had to base form of the verb." You will need to change "time" words as well as the verbs.

Example: He must buy a new computer today because his old one broke down last night.

He **had to buy** a new computer **yesterday** because his old one broke down **the night before last**.

1. We have to get some medicine for our son so that he will recover from his illness.

2. My sister has to take her car to the garage to have it repaired tomorrow afternoon.

3. Students must do all their homework before they come to school in the morning.

4. Bob has to fix his brother's bicycle so that he can ride to school next week.

5. Children have to obey their parents when they are young.

6. I must remove the weeds from my garden next spring.

7. You have to do a lot of homework this quarter.

8. The policeman on the corner has to direct traffic every morning this month.

9. The boys have to help their father clean the yard this weekend.

10. His mother must help him with his homework tonight.

11. She has to buy a birthday present for her daughter next week.

12. My friend must have his car repaired this afternoon.

13. The boys' mother has to prepare dinner for her sons.

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9.10: "Had To" Sentence Completion Exercise

"Had To" Sentence Completion Exercise

Exercise 46: Complete the following sentences, please. Use "had to" or a clause following because, although, or so which will complete the sentence.

1. He had to buy a new car because
2. Because he didn't have enough money to buy a house,
3. He failed the English course, so
4. Although I wanted to go to a movie last night,
5. We worked 15 hours overtime last week because
6. Because my friend had a broken leg,
7. The man needed to send a letter, so
8. The man's son cut his arm with a knife, so
9. I went to the store because
10. My car was low on gas, so
11. Although the woman was tired,
12. Because the boy's pants were torn,
13. He was very sick, so
14. Even though the teacher felt sick,

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9.11: Past Modal Exercise- Should Have + Past Participle

Past Modal Exercise: Should Have + Past Participle

Exercise 47: Consider the following situations and then tell what the people should or shouldn't have done, please.

1. The man lost all his money at the race track betting on horses.
2. The man's wife gave him some of her money so that he could gamble again.
3. My car broke down on the highway because the engine was low on oil.
4. My brother lost his job because he argued with his boss and told his boss that he quit.
5. While I was driving to school, I saw an accident in which a man drove through a red light while speeding.
6. My mother smoked all her life and died of lung cancer.
7. My friend borrowed \$1,000 from me and never paid me back.
8. Yesterday was my mother's birthday and I didn't buy her a present because I forgot it was her birthday.
9. Yesterday at work, my friend felt very bad because he had gotten drunk the night before and he had a very bad hangover in the morning.
10. I didn't go to bed until late last night because I had to write this exercise.
11. My students didn't do their homework.
12. The young girl drank too much wine and got very sick.
13. My son didn't call home because he forgot his phone in his house.

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9.12: Past Modal Exercise

Past Modal Exercise

Exercise 48: Respond to the following statements and questions, please. Make sure to use a past modal, please

1. Tell me about an obligation that you had as a young boy or girl.
2. What did I have for dinner last night?
3. My friend worked all day Saturday in his yard, from 8:00 AM until 6:00 PM. How did he feel at the end of the day? What did he do before he went to bed?
4. My younger son had the opportunity to attend the University of Washington, but he decided to attend the University of Puget Sound instead. It cost me a lot more money.
5. My son drove his car when it was low on oil and ruined the engine of the car.
6. When the robber put a gun to my head and demanded that I give him all of my money, what do you think I did?
7. Why didn't my son go to work last week?
8. My sister bought me a new shirt, but she didn't have any money with her. How did she pay for the shirt?
9. I got a \$2.00 fine from the library because I brought a book back late.
10. My friend's back hurt her last night after she got home from work. Why did it hurt?
11. My boss ate some spoiled meat last night. What happened?
12. My son broke up with his girlfriend. How did she feel?

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Exercise 49: Past Tense Modal Verb Exercise: Read the sentence and then make up a logical answer using a past tense modal verb, please.

1. The man told his mother that everyone was going to buy an expensive gift for a party, but he told his girlfriend that everyone was going to buy a cheap gift as a joke gift for the party. How did the mother feel when she gave an expensive necklace to the girlfriend but got a cheap gift from the girlfriend?
2. My younger son had the responsibility to take our dog for a walk as soon as he got home from work. What did my son do when he got home from work every day?

3. My brother-in-law on his honeymoon lost his wallet in the men's room at the Seattle Center. It had \$3000 in cash, all his credit cards, and his debit card inside the wallet. How did he feel? What did he do?
4. My friend and his wife went out to an expensive restaurant for their 35th wedding anniversary last Saturday evening. What did they order to eat?
5. I almost got married to a girl from Switzerland, another girl from England, and another one from America. However, I finally actually got married to a girl from Brazil. Use past modal verb and tell me about one of these girls, please.
6. A friend and his wife cleaned the house gutters on three houses on Saturday afternoon. They had to carry a big ladder from house to house, climb up the ladder and move the ladder many times in order to clean out the dirt, leaves, mud and water from the gutters, and then go home in the cold wet rain, carrying the ladder and other tools. How did they feel afterwards? Did they go dancing that night? How did they feel the next day?
7. Another friend left some of his tools outside on his back deck last Saturday when he had to go to the hardware store to buy some more screws and nails. When he got home, his tools were gone. What happened? What should he have done? What could he have done?

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10: Conjunctions

Conjunctions

Conjunctions are words that either join parts of speech or join sentences. There are seven conjunctions in English: and, but, for, so, or, yet, nor. Another way to remember what the conjunctions are is by the expression FAN BOYS (For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So). The difficulty with conjunctions is that they are also other parts of speech and therefore have different meanings. First, I will explain to you what these words mean as conjunction and then I will explain how they are used in different parts of speech.

“And” is used to join parts of speech that have an equal value as well as two complete sentences that have an equal value. Note the examples below.

Bob <u>and</u> John went to the market.	“And” joined two nouns.
He played football and went home.	“And” joined two verbs phrases.
She was a beautiful and intelligent woman.	“And” joined adjectives.
My wife cooked the food, and I washed the dishes.	“And” joined two sentences.
My son woke up, and my wife made his breakfast.	“And” joined two sentences.

“But” is used to show that two parts of speech are opposite as well as two halves of a sentence show an opposite idea. Note the sentences below.

My sons but not my wife watched the movie last night.	“But” joined two nouns.
He went to the part but didn’t eat anything.	“But” joined two verbs.
He was and old man but still strong.	“But” joined two adjectives.
His wife went to the celebration, but he stayed home.	“But” joined two sentences.
She lost her keys, but her son found them.	“But” joined two sentences.

“For” is used in the second half of a sentence and it has exactly the same meaning as “because.” It only joins sentences; it does not join parts of speech. It always has a comma in front of it. It is not used very often in modern English. Note the examples below.

You are coming to this class, for you want to learn correct grammar.
I have written this grammar handout, for I want you to learn correct grammar.

“So,” like **for**, does not join parts of speech, must come in the second half of a sentence, and have a comma in front of it. It means a second action is the result of a first action. Note the sentences below.

The man was sick, so he went to see a doctor.
The student didn’t study for the exam, so he failed it.

“Or” shows a choice. It can join parts of speech as well as sentences. Note the sentences below.

The boy didn’t know whether to eat ice cream or cake for dessert.	“Or” joined two nouns.
He couldn’t decide whether to stay home or go to the party.	“Or” joined two verb phrases.
He is either at home or in school.	“Or” joined two prepositional phrases.
He will drive there, or I will go and pick him up.	“Or” joined two sentences.
My wife will prepare dinner, or we will go to a restaurant.	“Or” joined two sentences.

“Yet” has the same basic meaning as **but**, but it is stronger. It can join parts of speech or sentences. Note the sentences below.

He would like to go with us, yet can’t. **“Yet”** joined opposite verb phrases.

He is physically weak yet mentally strong. **Yet** joined opposite adjective phrases.

He had his car repaired, yet it still won't start. **Yet** joined opposite sentences.

He would like to continue working, yet he is too tired. **Yet** joined two opposite sentences.

“Nor” means **“not or”**; in other words, there is no choice. It is always a “negative” word. Nor always comes in the middle of a negative sentence and always has a comma before it when it is used as a conjunction. It is often used with the word **“neither”** and a part of speech before it. When it joins sentences, it has what is known as stylistic inversion. Stylistic inversion is when a “statement” looks like a question, but it is not a question. Stylistic inversion is used in English when a negative word (usually an adverb) comes first in a sentence. Note the sentences below.

It is neither hot nor cold. “Nor” joined adjectives.

Neither the cat nor the dog likes the boy. “Nor” joined nouns.

He is not at home nor in school. “Nor” joined prepositional phrases.

The boy didn't come, nor did his parents. “Nor did his parents” means that his parent didn't come either.

The man doesn't like his neighbor, nor does his wife. “Nor does his wife” means that his wife doesn't like his neighbor either.

I can't do the math problem, nor can my sons. “Nor can my sons” means that my sons can't do the math problem either.

A further explanation of the use of conjunctions is on the next two pages. In addition to using these seven words as conjunctions, I have also shown how these words are used as other parts of speech.

Conjunctions can have two functions in English: (1) They can join parts of speech, and (2) they join two independent clauses (sentences). Using conjunctions is one way to form a compound sentence.

AND: Joining Parts of Speech

I have a book and a pencil. My older and heavier brother lives in Rhode Island. I like to eat and drink too much. That girl is intelligent and beautiful. My wife and I look fat and happy. She dances beautifully and gracefully. He drinks and smokes all the time.

AND: Compound Sentences

I like to eat pizza, and my brother likes to eat pasta. You study English, and I teach it. We work during the day, and we relax at night. My boys are nice kids, and they like to play with each other. I teach English, and my wife teaches cooking classes.

AND with no comma for simple sentences

I swam and played at the beach during my vacation. The man carried the woman's bags to her car and opened the door for her.

BUT: Compound Sentences

I come from America, but my wife comes from Brazil. I understand Portuguese, but I don't speak it. The weather in Seattle is bad, but I like this city. The girl was pretty, but her personality was bad.

SO: Compound Sentences

I needed to fix my basement, so I worked there all weekend long. You want to learn English, so you come to SSCC. I'm hungry, so I guess I'll eat something.

FOR: Compound Sentences

I must buy my friend a present, for it is her birthday this week. My wife was angry at my son, for he had not done his homework. I got paid on the 10th, for it was payday. We bought a new car, for our old one had broken down. He took a second job, for his family needed the money. She was crying, for her dog had been hit by a car. He had a party, for today was his birthday.

FOR: Preposition

I went to the market for some butter. He bought a present for his girlfriend. We went there for two days. He went to the library for a book. He got it for her. He knew a good place to go in the mountains for trout fishing.

YET: Compound Sentences

I ate a sandwich, yet I wasn't really hungry. He was wearing a short sleeve shirt, yet it was freezing outside. He knew the teacher would be angry, yet he didn't care. He saw the policeman, yet he continued to drive fast. She loved him, yet she killed him.

YET: Time

I haven't done my work yet. They aren't married yet. Is she awake yet? Can the baby walk yet? Will the boys be home from school yet? I haven't studied the verbs yet.

NOR: Joining Parts of Speech

Neither I nor John will go. I neither have nor want a new car. It is neither hot nor cold outside. He did it neither quickly nor accurately. Neither he nor I care for that man.

NOR: Compound Sentences

I can't speak Chinese, nor can my brother. I have never been to the North Pole, nor do I want to go there. He has not killed anyone, nor has he seen anyone killed. It isn't necessary to buy a lot of books on grammar, nor is it cheap. He isn't foolish, nor am I.

OR: Joining Parts of Speech

He wants a book or a cassette tape for his birthday. Bob or Bill will go with you. She is either in Europe or in Asia now. You can either come with us or stay at home.

OR: Compound Sentences

He will come, or I will stay with him. It will either be a nice day, or it will rain. You can help me do it, or your brother can take your place. You have to eat, or you will get sick. You had better do your homework, or the teacher will get angry at you.

Exercise 33: Correct the following sentences, please. Put in commas where they belong and take out commas where they don't belong. Also, look for other grammar mistakes. Be careful because some of the sentences are correct.

Examples:

He doesn't speak Chinese nor he doesn't speak Japanese.

He doesn't speak Chinese, nor does he speak Japanese.

My son, and my wife argue a lot about everything.

My son and my wife argue about everything.

1. I can speak French but I can write it well.
2. My sister and my wife like to talk on the phone a couple of times a week.
3. I haven't retired, yet.
4. We will go to France next year, or some friends will come to visit us.
5. My students do their homework and I correct it.
6. I will go home after I finish this student handout for I am getting tired.
7. My brother, my sister, my father and I all did what my mother said.
8. She is very beautiful but very stupid.
9. We lost our camera, nor did we lose our money.
10. She felt sick so she went to the hospital.
11. He had a lot of money in his pocket yet he stole something from the store.
12. His mother sent her son to the store, for some bread.
13. She wanted to buy some clothes and some furniture.
14. They had a party for today was her birthday.
15. She was very tired yet she had to go to work.

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